



CITY: Pg 2

Constable shoots wife dead on her birthday, flees



NATION: Pg 5

MLA poaching charges, BJP sends legal notice to J&K CM Omar



FILM: Pg 12

H'wood actor Sam Neill leaves the world at 78

Quick News

FIRE AT A MUSIC BAR IN BANGKOK KILLS AT LEAST 27 PEOPLE

BANGKOK: At least 27 people were killed and 73 injured, including 25 in critical condition, after a fire swept through Bangkok's Rong Beer Na Ladprao music bar before midnight Sunday, the city's deadliest blaze in 17 years. Police said many victims were trapped in bathrooms. "Everything went dark," a survivor said. Investigators are examining the cause. SeeP8



OVER 81L WOMEN REMOVED FROM MAHA'S 'LADKI BAHIN' SCHEME

MUMBAI: More than 81 lakh women have been removed from Maharashtra's Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana after verification found failures in e-KYC, income and age eligibility. When the scheme was launched, 2.47 crore women became beneficiaries and received monthly financial assistance. Meanwhile, the CAG flagged Rs 3,541.16 crore in excess expenditure and financial irregularities, including parking Rs 15,586 crore in deposit accounts, in implementing the welfare scheme. See P6

RAM TEMPLE DONATION THEFT

Top Court seeks status report from UP SIT; issues notice to Trust

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday sought a status report from the Special Investigation Team (SIT) set up by the Uttar Pradesh government to investigate allegations of misappropriation of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya. The court also issued notice to the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on petitions seeking a fair, transparent and time-bound investigation into the alleged financial irregularities. The development came on the same day that a special anti-corruption court in Faizabad extended the judicial custody of eight accused in the case by another 14 days, till July 27.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohan directed the state-appointed SIT to place a status report before the court. Continued on P4

Suspended employee arrested in Badrinath temple donation case

DEHRADUN: The Uttarakhand Police have arrested suspended Shri Badrinath-Kedarnath Temple Committee (BKTC) employee Pramod Nautiyal in connection with alleged irregularities in the handling of donations at the Badrinath temple, officials said on Monday.

Chamoli Senior Superintendent of Police Surjit Singh Panwar said Nautiyal was arrested from his residence on Sunday night and taken to Badrinath, where he is being questioned. Continued on P4

Ram Temple Trust invites applications for CEO

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has invited applications for the post of Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, with the recruitment process beginning amid efforts to strengthen the temple's administrative

system following the recent donation theft scandal.

According to the notification issued by the Trust, the CEO will be appointed for an initial term of three years, which may be extended. The salary and service benefits will be decided through mutual negotiations. The selected candidate will be required to Continued on P4

Citizenship must be decided through fair process, says SC

BARS COERCIVE ACTION AGAINST 27 DECLARED FOREIGNERS IN ASSAM, ORDERS FRESH REVIEW

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The process of determining citizenship or declaring someone a foreigner should be made through a fair, lawful and reasoned process, the Supreme Court said Monday in a critical judgement on the citizenship status of 27 individuals who had been labelled 'foreigners' by tribunals in Assam.

"Citizenship and foreigner status occupy a field of high constitutional and legal significance," the court observed.

Simultaneously, the court also admitted the Indian government had an appreciable interest in preventing individuals' illegal claims to citizenship, noting, "The State has a legitimate and compelling interest in ensuring that persons who are not legally entitled to claim Indian citizenship do not secure such status by misuse of



COURT SAYS ARTICLES 14 AND 21 PROTECT EVERY PERSON IN INDIA

process, by false claim or delays..." However, in the final analysis, the court said that interest cannot override judicial fairness. The top court then set aside

judgements passed down by the Gauhati High Court and the tribunals, and stressed that no coercive action could be taken against the 27 individuals who had been

labelled 'foreigners' until another hearing is held by the tribunals. Of the 27, Sabitri Dey, Ajbahar Ali, Md Akbar Ali, Abeda Khatun, and Anowara Continued on P4

CLOSER LOOK

- » Bench sets aside Gauhati High Court and tribunal orders against all 27 appellants
- » No coercive action against 27 appellants until fresh tribunal hearings
- » Tribunals directed to reconsider cases independently, ignoring earlier findings
- » Court says citizenship questions carry high constitutional and legal significance
- » State can prevent illegal citizenship claims through lawful procedures
- » Judicial fairness cannot be sacrificed despite government's legitimate interest

TRUMP REIMPOSES BLOCKADE

'US to charge 20% on cargo shipped through Hormuz'

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: US President Donald Trump said Monday that the United States is "reinstating" a blockade on Iran in the Strait of Hormuz and will charge ships for safe passage,

after another heavy exchange of fire threatened negotiations aimed at ending the war.

He said on social media that Iranian ships will no longer be able to travel through the strait and America would charge a 20 per cent toll on eli-

gible cargo, as the conflict with Iran has intensified after peace talks failed to deliver meaningful progress.

"We are reinstating the THE IRANIAN BLOCKADE, so named because it is only stopping Iran's ships or cus-

tomers from entering or leaving," Trump said online. "All other countries will have fair and open use of the Strait." The president said the toll would help cover "any and all costs necessary to do the job of providing safety Continued on P4

DRIVEN BY HIGHER FOOD PRICES Retail inflation rises to 4.38% in June

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Retail inflation rose to 4.38 per cent in June, crossing the Reserve Bank of India's 4 per cent median target for the first time under the revised Consumer Price Index (CPI) series that came into effect in January this year, according to government data released on Monday. The increase was mainly driven by higher food prices.

The National Statistics Office (NSO) said CPI-based inflation climbed from 3.93 per cent in May to 4.38 per cent in June. The new inflation series uses 2024 as the base year. Food inflation also moved higher, rising to 5.32 per cent in June from 4.78 per cent in the previous month.

Among individual items, silver, gold, diamond and platinum jewellery recorded some of the sharpest price increases, along with ginger, tomato, raisins and monacca. In contrast, prices of potatoes, peas, motor cars and jeeps, cumin, and motorcy-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Rural inflation at 4.74%, urban inflation at 3.92%
- » Telangana records highest inflation at 6.36%; Mizoram lowest at 1.63%

cles and scooters remained among the weakest contributors to inflation.

Inflation in rural India stood at 4.74 per cent, higher than the urban rate of 3.92 per cent. Among states, Telangana recorded the highest retail inflation at 6.36 per cent, while Mizoram reported the lowest at 1.63 per cent.

The RBI is mandated to keep retail inflation at 4 per cent, with a tolerance band of 2 percentage points on either side. Inflation remains a key factor in the central bank's monetary policy decisions.

At its June policy meeting, the RBI kept the benchmark interest rate unchanged but raised its inflation forecast for Continued on P4

SC flags misuse of POCSO in consensual teenage relationships

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday questioned how the State could prevent a boy and a girl in a relationship from eloping, while raising concerns over the use of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act in cases involving consensual relationships between teenagers.

Hearing a suo motu case on the right to privacy of adolescents, a bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and R Mahadevan observed that parents often initiate criminal proceedings to protect their "honour" when teenage girls leave home with their partners. Continued on P4

TAKEAWAYS

- » Court asks Centre to examine the plea through relevant authorities
- » Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology identified as key authority
- » Bench says technological solutions and expert input are essential



- » Petition sought safeguards against minors accessing online pornography
- » Plea also sought a ban on viewing pornography in public places

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday described the issue of minors accessing online pornographic content as one of "paramount public importance" but said it falls within the domain of policy rather than judicial intervention. Refusing to issue directions on a public interest litigation seeking a national action plan to curb the viewing of pornography, particularly by minors, the court asked that the plea be treated as a representation to the Union government for consideration. The bench said the matter requires technological solutions and expert input, particularly from the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, while expressing confidence that the authori-

ties would examine the concerns raised.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohan heard the petition filed by social worker B L Jain and represented by advocate Varun Thakur.

The petition sought directions to the Centre to frame a national policy and action

plan to prevent minors from accessing pornographic material online and to prohibit the viewing of pornography in public places.

"The issue raised is of paramount public importance. However, the subject matter does not involve a question of law requiring examination by this court. Continued on P4

Court convicts Tahir Hussain, 4 others in IB officer murder case

IB officer Ankit Sharma was killed during the 2020 northeast Delhi riots

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Monday convicted former Aam Aadmi Party councillor Tahir Hussain and four others in the 2020 murder of Intelligence Bureau officer Ankit Sharma, whose body was recovered from a drain during the northeast Delhi riots. The court held Hussain guilty of murder and several other offences linked to the communal violence, while acquitting him of charges of criminal conspiracy and abetment. Six other accused were acquitted. The verdict comes more than six years after the riots that claimed 53 lives and left scores injured during protests against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act.

Additional Sessions Judge Praveen Singh pronounced the verdict in the presence of all the accused. Hussain broke down in court after being convicted, while his lawyer tried to console him.

At the time of the incident, Hussain was an elected councillor of the Aam Aadmi Party. He was later suspended by the party after his name surfaced in the case.

The court convicted Hussain under provisions of the Indian Penal Code relating to



Tahir Hussain FILE PHOTO

KEY POINTS

- » Court convicted Hussain of murder, rioting and promoting enmity
- » Hussain was acquitted of criminal conspiracy and abetment charges
- » Nazim, Qasim, Javed and Anas were convicted on multiple charges except murder
- » Court ordered Javed and Anas, out on bail, into custody
- » Detailed judgment is awaited; sentencing date is yet to be fixed

murder, promoting enmity, rioting, rioting with deadly weapons, unlawful assembly and assault committed in furtherance of a common object. However, he was acquitted of charges under Continued on P4

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Every promise must reach the ground: CM

SAYS FOCUS IS ON DELIVERING EV PUSH, WOMEN’S WELFARE, SAFETY, TRAFFIC FIXES AND CIVIC WORKS

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: From defending Delhi’s ambitious electric vehicle transition to outlining plans for women’s financial empowerment, women safety, tackling traffic congestion and addressing civic issues, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said her government is focusing on implementation as much as policy. In a conversation with *Millennium Post*, Gupta said every major initiative announced by the government is being backed by infrastructure, technology and administrative preparedness to ensure timely execution.

Responding to criticism over whether Delhi has the infrastructure to support its recently notified EV Policy, the Chief Minister said the government has already begun expanding the ecosystem required for a smooth transition.

“Some people have raised concerns about whether Delhi

has adequate infrastructure to support the EV Policy. We are addressing every requirement alongside its implementation, whether it is charging stations, power supply or any other supporting infrastructure,” Gupta said.

She said Delhi already has around 9,000 EV charging points, with a target to expand the network to nearly 32,000. “We are working with DISCOMs, RWAs, commercial establishments and private partners to ensure charging facilities are available across residential colonies, offices, markets, parking areas and public spaces. Our objective is to make EV charging easily accessible throughout the city,” she said.

Calling it a comprehensive mobility roadmap, Gupta added, “This policy is not just about subsidies; it creates a complete ecosystem by promoting infrastructure, supporting manufacturers, attracting investment and



generating employment.”

Addressing concerns over women’s safety, Gupta said the government continues to work closely with the Delhi Police while strengthening long-term support systems for women. “Women’s safety remains one of our highest priorities. The

THE BIG PUSH

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» We are working with DISCOMs, RWAs, commercial establishments and private partners to ensure charging facilities are available across residential colonies, offices, markets, parking areas and public spaces

oment of society. Through the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, we want to ensure that every eligible woman has a dependable source of financial support. The scheme will be implemented in a transparent manner, and beneficiaries will start receiving assistance once the registration and verification process is completed” she said.

The Chief Minister added that this scheme would be implemented with “complete transparency and accountability” and that eligible beneficiaries would begin receiving financial assistance after the registration and verification process is completed.

On improvement in waterlogging and development works in areas such as Tughlakabad, Gupta said the government has directed elected representatives and officials to ensure effective utilisation of funds.

“Every MLA and the concerned departments have been

Creative degrees get a major boost

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Skill and Entrepreneurship University (DSEU) has signed a five-year memorandum of understanding with Maya Academy of Advanced Creativity (MAAC) to launch university-recognised degree programmes in the creative arts, the Delhi government said on Monday.

The partnership, signed with MEL Training & Assessments Limited, the parent company of MAAC, aims to combine industry-oriented training with formal higher education in animation, visual effects, gaming and other creative disciplines.

Under the agreement, MAAC will design the curriculum and facilitate industry placements, while DSEU will provide academic infrastructure, conduct examinations and award degrees.

HIGHLIGHTS

» Under the agreement, MAAC will design the curriculum and facilitate industry placements, while DSEU will provide academic infrastructure, conduct examinations and award degrees

» The programmes will be aligned with the National Education Policy and the National Credit Framework

» The government was working to position the national capital as a hub for the country’s growing ‘Orange Economy’, comprising creative and cultural industries: Minister

Delhi’s Lakshmi Yojana nears rollout

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government on Monday moved a step closer to launching its flagship monthly financial assistance programme for women, renaming the proposed Mahila Samridhhi Yojana as ‘Delhi Lakshmi Yojana’ and finalising its eligibility criteria. The scheme, under which eligible women will receive Rs 2,500 every month, is now expected to be rolled out around Raksha Bandhan next month.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta reviewed the implementation of the scheme at a high-level meeting at the Delhi Secretariat and directed officials to ensure that the benefits reach eligible women in a “transparent, simple and time-bound manner”

The govt said women or families with criminal records will not be eligible for the scheme

without administrative delays.

Announcing the new name, Gupta said, “‘Delhi Lakshmi Yojana’ will provide financial support to lakhs of women in need. Eligible women will receive Rs 2,500 every month, strengthening their dignity, confidence and economic empowerment.” She said the initiative aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of women-led development. “When a woman in a household becomes financially secure, it accelerates the progress of the family, society and the nation alike,” the Chief Minister said, adding that

qualify. Families owning a four-wheeler will also be excluded from the scheme. In a significant addition to the eligibility conditions, the government said women or families with criminal records will not be eligible for the scheme. Officials said the provision is intended to ensure that the benefits reach genuine beneficiaries. The government estimates that the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana will directly benefit lakhs of women across the capital by improving household financial stability and encouraging greater economic participation. According to officials, the scheme is expected to become one of the Delhi government’s flagship welfare initiatives aimed at strengthening women’s financial independence and social empowerment.



AI to take on dust

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a twin push to tackle Delhi’s persistent air pollution, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday launched an AI-powered platform to monitor dust emissions from construction sites in real time while simultaneously urging citizens to join the government’s ambitious campaign to plant 70 lakh saplings across the Capital. The government said technology-driven enforcement and large-scale greening together would form the backbone of its clean air strategy.

Launching Dust Portal 2.0, an AI-enabled web portal and mobile application developed by the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC), Gupta said the platform would transform the monitoring of construction and demolition sites by using GIS mapping, 360-degree cameras, PM10 and PM2.5 sensors and artificial intelligence.

“AI and digital technology are making compliance simpler, monitoring more effective and enforcement more transparent,” the Chief Minister said, adding that every construction agency would become “an active partner in building a cleaner and pollution-free Delhi.”

AI and digital technology are making compliance simpler, monitoring more effective and enforcement more transparent — CM

per cent of PM10 and 38 per cent of PM2.5 emissions.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said construction sites measuring 500 square yards or more would now be monitored using AI. “The new AI-based system will enable real-time monitoring of compliance, issue immediate alerts in case of violations and ensure strict action against repeat offenders,” he said, adding that the portal would “set a new benchmark for dust pollution control.” Gupta also joined a plantation drive in Model Town under the ‘Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam’ and ‘Green Delhi Sankalp’ campaigns, as part of Delhi’s 70 lakh plantation campaign where around 1,100 saplings were planted along central verges, beneath Metro corridors and on roadsides. Calling on residents to participate in the campaign, Gupta said, “Every sapling symbolises the commitment to providing future generations with clean air, greenery and a healthy life.”

She said the government had launched a dedicated portal to enable citizens to book plantation slots and receive free saplings through the Vriksh Rath initiative. “The Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam campaign is not merely a tree-planting initiative but a people’s movement that reflects respect for nature, the environment and motherhood,” she said, urging Delhiites to help the government achieve its target of planting 70 lakh saplings this year.

TO REPLACE OLD COMMERCIAL VEHICLES DELHI GOVT to implement Centre’s ‘Naya Safar Yojana’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has initiated the process to implement the Centre’s ‘Naya Safar Yojana’, a scheme aimed at replacing old trucks and buses operating in Delhi-NCR with cleaner BS-VI and electric vehicles to curb vehicular pollution.

Announcing the move on Monday, Transport Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh said the initiative would encourage voluntary replacement of BS-IV and older commercial vehicles through financial incentives, tax concessions and scrap-age-linked benefits. Under the scheme, owners purchasing eligible new vehicles will receive a 100 per cent concession on Motor Vehicle Tax, while eligible used vehicles will be granted a 50 per cent tax concession for 10 years. Beneficiaries will also be



eligible for waiver of registration fees and pending road tax and fitness penalty liabilities. These incentives will be in addition to benefits offered by the Central government, including interest subvention, fuel vouchers or one-time EV incentives, and discounts from participating manufacturers.

“The implementation of the ‘Naya Safar Yojana’ represents a significant step towards replacing ageing, highly polluting commercial vehicles with cleaner BS-VI and electric alternatives. This initiative

will accelerate Delhi’s transition to cleaner commercial mobility, reduce vehicular pollution and improve the quality of life for citizens while supporting transport operators in modernising their fleets,” Singh said. According to the government, nearly 2.07 lakh truck and bus owners across Delhi-NCR are expected to benefit from the scheme. In Delhi, all Light Goods Vehicles purchased under the scheme must be electric, while buses must be BS-VI CNG or electric.

The scheme has a total outlay of Rs. 9,585 crore, of which the Central government will contribute Rs. 5,041 crore through the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB). It will be implemented through a digital Naya Safar Portal for eligibility verification, benefit disbursement and monitoring, and will remain open for eligible beneficiaries for two years.

PWD plans revamp of ITO pump house

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The PWD is planning to take upgradation work of the ITO pump house, which caters to several areas around the area, officials said on Monday.

The ITO pump house is responsible for areas along the Vikas Marg, near Supreme Court metro station, and Tilak Bridge underpass, all of which remain on the watchlist of waterlogging hotspots for the Public Works Department (PWD). “We plan to install an all-weather sub station at ITO pump house, so that the power supply to the pumping systems remains uninterrupted even during heavy rains and winds. Automatic digital alarm systems will also be installed,” a senior PWD official said.

As part of monsoon preparation, last year, the PWD remodelled drain number 5, which runs from Azad Bhawan to the IP Estate area. This area, which has several government

offices, connected to the ITO pumping station having four permanent pumps. According to officials, conventionally oil cooled transformers were being used for electrical sub-station but in this case the systems have been changed. At the cost of Rs 1.3 crore the revamp work will be carried out which has to be completed in three months time.

“However due to presence of oil for cooling of transformers, an inherent fire risk is involved in the use of oil cooled transformers. After repeated fire accidents due to burning of oil in those transformers, rules have been amended to provide for use of only dry type transformers,” the tender states. For the past few years ITO and Ring Road stretch near Indraprastha have been witnessing repeated waterlogging episodes. To further strengthen its response to flooding in low-lying areas, the PWD has increased the number of permanent pump houses equipped with automatic pumps.

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 38.6 degrees Celsius on Monday, 3.1 notches above normal, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The city’s base weather station at Safdarjung recorded the maximum temperature at 38.6 degrees Celsius. In comparison, Palam logged 38 degrees Celsius, Lodhi Road 38.1 degrees Celsius, Ridge 37.4 degrees Celsius and Ayanagar 37.7 degrees Celsius, the IMD said. The weather department has forecast a partly cloudy sky on Tuesday, with maximum and minimum temperatures expected to settle around 36 and 27 degrees Celsius, respectively. On Sunday, the city recorded a maximum temperature of 36.8 degrees Celsius. No rainfall was recorded at any of these stations between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, or during the preceding 24 hours ending at 8.30 am. Further, Delhi’s 24-hour average air quality remained ‘poor’ on Monday at 4 pm, with the average Air Quality Index (AQI) hovering at 246, according to the Central Pollution Control Board.

As per CPCB standards, an AQI between zero and 50 is considered ‘good’, 51 to 100 ‘satisfactory’, 101 to 200 ‘moderate’, 201 to 300 ‘poor’, 301 to 400 ‘very poor’, and 401 to 500 ‘severe’.

Earlier in the day, the minimum temperature at Safdarjung settled at 29.1 degrees Celsius, 1.8 notches above normal. Palam recorded a minimum of 26.8 degrees Celsius, according to the IMD.

MP0ST

City gets warmer at 38.6 deg C

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MP0ST

MCD awards waste processing contracts across five locations

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi has awarded contracts to process nearly 5,900 metric tonnes of fresh municipal waste daily at five locations, including landfill sites at Okhla, Bhalswa and Ghazipur, officials said on Monday.

According to the officials, under the contracts, Bhalswa will process 1,800 metric tonnes

of fresh waste daily, Okhla 1,400 metric tonnes, Narela-Bawana 1,200 metric tonnes, Ghazipur 800 metric tonnes and Singhola 700 metric tonnes.

To prevent the accumulation of new garbage at landfill sites while legacy waste remediation continues, the officials said the contracts have been awarded to different firms, which will now set up the required facilities

and begin processing of fresh waste once the infrastructure is in place.

The civic body has been working to clear legacy waste at the Ghazipur, Bhalswa and Okhla landfill sites. The earlier deadline of July 2026 to clear Okhla and Bhalswa has already been shifted to December 2026, and Ghazipur is scheduled for December 2027.

MP0ST

AFTER RAM TEMPLE THEFT

Temples insist on pocketless clothing for donation counting staff

OUR CORRESPONDENT

HAMIRPUR/PALANPUR: The alleged theft of offerings at the Ram temple in Ayodhya has prompted the management of other prominent temples to bring in stricter rules for the counting process, including specific dress code requiring the staff to wear pocketless clothing.

The Baba Balak Nath Temple in Himachal Pradesh's Hamirpur and Gujarat's famous Ambaji temple are among the temples that have introduced such rules.

The Karnataka government also has issued an SOP aimed at ensuring security, transparency and accountability of donations at state-run temples.

According to the Balak Nath Temple trust, cash offerings are already counted under a prescribed procedure in the presence of authorised staff and officials and under CCTV



surveillance.

The mandatory use of pocketless clothing has now been added as another safeguard to ensure transparency, honesty and accountability in the counting process.

The decision was implemented on the instructions of Hamirpur Deputy Commissioner and Sidh Baba Balak Nath Temple Trust Chairperson Gandharva Rathore.

The new dress code requires all staff involved in counting offerings to wear garments

without pockets, a temple trust spokesperson said.

Rathore said the proposal had been under consideration for a long time and has now been brought into effect from Monday.

The Baba Balak Nath Temple at Deotsidh, one of the major temples in the state controlled by the Himachal Pradesh government under the HP Endowment Temples Act, receives nearly 70 to 80 lakh pilgrims annually.

The Ambaji temple has

implemented a strict standard operating procedure for counting donations, featuring live public telecasts and multiple security checks to boost transparency, months after a theft attempt, officials said on Monday. Under the revised SOP, the entire counting process will be monitored by more than 20 CCTV cameras, and the footage will be preserved for six months.

All employees involved in counting donations will undergo frisking with metal

detectors in the presence of police before entering the counting room. They will also not be allowed to wear clothes with large pockets during the exercise, he said.

The move has come after an old CCTV footage of an outsourced employee attempting to steal Rs 1 lakh from the cash room of the shrine in Banaskantha district two months ago went viral online.

The new measures were introduced to make the donation-counting process more robust and transparent, said Mihir Patel, Banaskantha collector and the managing trustee of the Shri Arasuri Ambaji Mata Devsthan Trust.

"The three employees were dismissed from service with immediate effect back then. Following that, a new SOP has been announced to strengthen the donation counting process," Patel told reporters here.

FOUR UNDER TREATMENT

Gujarat: Three children die of Chandipura virus in latest outbreak

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GANDHINAGAR: Gujarat has reported seven confirmed cases of the Chandipura virus (CHPV) in the last few weeks, of which three patients have died, while four are under medical treatment, Health Minister Prafull Pansheriya said on Monday.

All the patients were under the age of 10, he said.

The minister, who chaired a high-level meeting in Gandhinagar to review the CHPV outbreak in the state, said blood sample reports of eight suspected patients of the virus are still awaited.

The health department is continuously working towards control of the virus, treatment of patients and surveillance operations, he maintained.

The Chandipura virus causes fever, with symptoms similar to flu, and acute encephalitis (inflammation of the brain). The pathogen is a member of the Vesiculovirus genus of the family Rhabdo-

viridae. It is transmitted by vectors like mosquitoes, ticks and sandflies.

"Blood samples of 27 suspected patients of the virus were earlier sent for testing. Of these, reports of seven came positive, while 12 tested negative. Results of eight patients are pending and they are expected by this evening (Monday). Of the seven confirmed cases, three patients have died, while four patients - two each in Gandhinagar and Vadnagar (Mehsana district) - are under treatment," he informed.

The health department is taking the help of the Indian Medical Association, and child specialists of Gujarat have been asked to work in coordination to deal with the outbreak, Pansheriya said.

"Doctors running small health centres and private clinics have been instructed that if they come across suspicious cases, they should not waste time and immediately admit patients and provide oxygen and ventilator facilities to them

so that precious lives can be saved," he stated.

The minister further said that in 2024, cases of Chandipura virus were reported from 61 places in the state, where the health department undertook fogging operations to prevent mosquito, sand fly breeding and launched public awareness programmes.

"No new case has been reported from any of these 61 places. Even in the new areas where patients have been found, the administration has immediately carried out fogging, spraying and sanitisation to kill sandflies that spread the disease," he said.

Adequate quantities of medicine and necessary medical supplies have been made available to even the smallest health centres in the state to prevent the spread of the virus, Pansheriya added.

The virus was first isolated from a patient in Chandipura village in Nagpur district of Maharashtra in 1965.

From Page 1

Citizenship

Khatun had approached the top court alleging that they had been declared foreigners on hyper-technical grounds, such as typos and minor mismatches in the spellings of their names on old voter lists.

The protection of equality before law, equal protection of laws, life and personal liberty is available to every person within the territory of India, it stressed, adding it has not examined the merits of the claim of citizenship by the appellants.

It asked the tribunals concerned to decide the references afresh, uninfluenced by any earlier observation by the high court or by the tribunals.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said the State has a legitimate and compelling interest in ensuring that persons who are not legally entitled to claim Indian citizenship do not secure such status by misuse of process, by false claims or by taking advantage of procedural delays.

"At the same time, the determination of such status must be made through a process which is fair, lawful and reasoned," the bench said.

While setting aside the orders passed by the high court, the bench remitted the matters to the Foreigners Tribunals concerned for fresh adjudication in accordance with law.

The top court delivered its verdict on a batch of appeals arising out of proceedings before the Foreigners Tribunals in Assam. In some matters, the proceedings took place before the erstwhile Illegal Migrants (Determination) Tribunals.

The bench noted that in all these matters, the appellants were declared to be foreigners and the said opinions were affirmed by the High Court.

The bench said citizenship and foreigner status occupy a field of high constitutional and legal significance.

"Article 11 of the Constitution preserves the power of Parliament to make provisions with respect to the acquisition and termination of citizenship and all other matters relating to citizenship," it said.

The top court said separately, the Foreigners Act, 1946, and the Foreigners (Tribunals) Order, 1964 provide the statutory mechanism through which questions as to whether a person is or is not a foreigner are referred to and determined by the tribunal.

The bench noted that its order was not intended to confer any equity in favour of a person who is unable to establish his or her claim in accordance with law.

"It is only to ensure that the serious consequence of being declared a foreigner follows from an adjudication which satisfies the requirements of the 1946 Act, the 1964 Order, and the constitutional mandate of fairness," it said.

The bench said the protection of equality before law, equal protection of laws, life and personal liberty is available to every person within the territory of India.

"A person proceeded against before a Foreigners Tribunal may ultimately fail to establish Indian citizenship, but the process by which such determination is made must still satisfy the constitutional requirements of fairness, reasonableness and non-arbitrariness," it said.

The bench said the apex court has consistently recognised that even a foreigner is entitled to the protection of life and personal liberty under Article 21 of the Constitution.

It said Article 14 of the Constitution also upholds the content of fair procedure.

The bench observed that a State action which is arbitrary cannot claim the protection of law merely because it is clothed in statutory form.

"A proceeding which may result in a person being declared a foreigner cannot be sustained if the procedure adopted is mechanical, one-sided, or devoid of application of mind. Equal protection of laws requires that the statutory procedure be applied in a real and meaningful manner," it said.

The bench noted the common grievance of the appellants was that the opinions against them were rendered in proceedings which were either ex-parte or had become effectively ex-parte, and that the statutory determination of their status was made without a full and meaningful opportunity to contest the reference.

The top court made clear that it has not examined the merits of the claim of citizenship set up by any of the appellants.

It asked the concerned tribunals to decide the references afresh, uninfluenced by any observation made either by the high court or by the tribunals in the earlier opinions.

It said the concerned tribunals shall make an endeavour to decide the references as expeditiously as possible, preferably within six months from the date on which the appellants first appear before them pursuant to the apex court judgement.

In a related development on the citizenship issue, four persons from West Bengal's Birbhum district who were forced into Bangladesh in June 2025 were brought back to India earlier this month.

Sunali Khatun, her husband and their son, as well as another woman, Sweety Bibi and her two sons, had been taken into custody in Delhi and sent to Bangladesh. The six persons maintain that they hail from Birbhum district.

On May 22, the Union government had told the Supreme Court that it would bring back the persons who had been forced into the neighbouring country to verify their citizenship.

Calcutta High Court order that had set aside the deportation order against all six of them and the Centre had challenged it before the apex court.

Since the terror attack in Jammu and Kashmir's Pahalgam in April 2025, the police in several BJP-ruled states have been detaining Bengali-speaking persons - mostly Muslims - and asking them to prove that they are Indian citizens.

Tahir Hussain

Sections 120B dealing with criminal conspiracy and 109 relating to abetment.

The court also convicted Nazim, Qasim, Javed and Anas on charges similar to Hussain, except the offence of murder. At the same time, Haseen alias Mullaji alias Salman, Firoz, Gulfam, Soyab, Sameer Khan and Muntajim alias Musa were acquitted.

Following the verdict, the judge directed police to take Anas and Javed into custody as they had been

out on bail. The detailed judgement is yet to be released, and the court has not fixed a date for hearing arguments on the quantum of sentence.

The case arose from a complaint filed at Dayalpur police station by Ravinder Kumar, father of Ankit Sharma.

According to the complaint, Sharma, who worked with the Intelligence Bureau, returned home from work on February 25, 2020, before stepping out again. When he did not return, his family began searching for him. They were later informed by local residents that he had been killed and that his body had been thrown into the Khajuri Khas drain near a mosque in the Chand Bagh Pulia area. His body was later recovered from the drain.

Kumar alleged in his complaint that Hussain and others had murdered his son after assembling at Hussain's office and later disposed of the body.

The court had framed charges against Hussain and 10 others on March 24, 2023.

According to the police chargesheet, Hussain was leading a mob from his house and from a mosque near Chand Bagh Pulia on February 24 and 25, 2020. Investigators alleged that he gave the violence a communal colour by provoking members of the crowd with claims that Hindus had attacked Muslims and set shops on fire at Sherpur Chowk.

The chargesheet alleged that following these statements, the mob turned violent, set shops ablaze, pelted stones and petrol bombs, and targeted Hindu houses. It further claimed that the mob caught hold of Sharma, dragged him to Chand Bagh Pulia, assaulted him with sharp and blunt weapons, killed him and dumped his body in the drain.

Special Public Prosecutor Madhukar Pandey said the judgment was not a victory for either side.

"It is society that has lost. The victim's family has suffered, and now the families of the convicted accused will also suffer. In such cases, everyone loses," he said after the verdict.

Reacting to the judgment, Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Gochha, who served as Special Commissioner of Police during the 2020 riots and led the investigation, said the force had focused on maintaining law and order while conducting a fair, impartial and evidence-based probe.

"Every effort was made to collect credible evidence and bring those responsible before the law. With the court delivering its judgment, I feel satisfied that the hard work and professionalism of the investigating team have stood the test of judicial scrutiny. We remain committed to bringing all those responsible for crimes committed during the 2020 riots to justice through the due process of law," he said.

US to charge

and security to this very volatile section of the World."

A fifth of the world's oil and gas passed through the strait before Iran asserted control over it after the start of the war.

The latest exchange of fire was sparked by an Iranian attack on a container ship on Sunday in the Strait of Hormuz. Iran has asserted control over the critical waterway for international oil and gas since

the United States and Israel started the war on Feb. 28.

Iran says it has the right to manage traffic through the strait and potentially charge fees in accordance with an interim peace deal reached last month. The US and others dispute that, citing international law on freedom of navigation, and the American military has tried to establish an alternative route outside of Iranian control.

Iran and the US are nearly half-way through the 60-day period in which they were supposed to negotiate a permanent end to the war and an agreement on Iran's disputed nuclear programme. Instead, a series of attacks over the strait have raised fears of a return to all-out war and further disruption to the global economy.

Oil prices jumped nearly 5 per cent on Monday before falling back. US benchmark crude, which had risen to nearly USD 120 a barrel at the height of the war, was trading at around USD 72.92. Markets were mixed.

Top Court

Three separate petitions have sought an independent investigation into the allegations. One, filed by Narendra Kumar Goswami, has requested a CBI probe and a Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audit of the finances of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, which manages the temple. Another petition by advocates Ajay Kumar Rai and Dinesh Kumar Yadav has sought similar relief, while a third petition by RJD MP Sudhakar Singh has sought a Supreme Court-monitored CBI investigation along with a forensic audit of the Trust's finances.

The petition filed by Rai and Yadav argued that a CBI-led multidisciplinary SIT should investigate the alleged financial irregularities and other purported illegalities involving the Trust's administration. It also sought directions to the Centre, the Uttar Pradesh government and the Trust to establish regulatory, supervisory and audit mechanisms to protect public interest and maintain the confidence of millions of devotees and donors.

The plea said reports of missing funds and alleged irregularities had caused concern among devotees, irrespective of whether the allegations were ultimately proven. It also questioned the state SIT's inquiry, saying it began without registration of an FIR or a regular criminal case.

The Uttar Pradesh government constituted the SIT on June 13 following a request from the temple trust after allegations of diversion of donation money surfaced. The panel comprises Lucknow Divisional Commissioner Vijay Vish was Pant, Inspector General of Police Kiran S and Special Secretary (Finance) Neel Ratan.

Meanwhile, the special anti-corruption court in Faizabad extended the judicial custody of all eight accused after they were produced through video conferencing before Additional District Judge Pratibha Narayan. The prosecution has sought police remand of Ramashankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav and Subhash Srivastava, with the court set to decide the request on July 14.

According to the prosecution, statements made by the two accused have provided fresh leads, making custodial interrogation necessary to verify facts and recover evidence linked to the alleged diversion

of temple donations. Tinnu Yadav, a former driver of Champat Rai, was reportedly responsible for the keys of the donation boxes, while former bank employee Subhash Srivastava oversaw the donation counting process.

Police have already questioned Avinash Shukla, Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra and Karunesh Pandey during separate periods of police custody and said they collected key evidence. The eight accused named in the SIT report are Avinash Shukla, Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Subhash Srivastava and Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu.

Badrinath

He had served as the personal assistant to the BKTC chairman before being suspended.

Panwar said a case was registered at the Badrinath police station on July 8 based on a complaint filed by BKTC official Yudhvir Farswan, who accused Nautiyal of misappropriating temple offerings. An FIR was lodged late Tuesday night.

According to the police, a preliminary investigation and CCTV footage indicated that Nautiyal allegedly removed cash and other items from the temple offerings. Based on the available evidence, he was taken into custody.

The BKTC's four-member inquiry committee had also found the allegations of irregularities in donation management against Nautiyal to be prima facie true. The BKTC is the statutory body responsible for managing the Badrinath temple and several other shrines in Uttarakhand.

The arrest has sparked a political exchange between the ruling BJP and the Congress.

Congress state president and former BKTC president Ganesh Godiyal questioned the fairness of the investigation, alleging that the arrested employee was being pressured not to reveal the names of others. He said the probe could not be trusted unless the BKTC president was removed and action was taken against him.

Responding to the allegations, BJP state president Mahendra Bhatt said the alleged misappropriation of offerings made to the Badrinath temple was "a grave sin." He said the government would not protect anyone found guilty and described Nautiyal's arrest as proof that action was being taken impartially. Bhatt also called for legal action against any other person found involved.

Last week, the Uttarakhand government formed a three-member committee headed by the Garhwal division commissioner to investigate the allegations. The panel will submit its findings and recommendations to the state government. The controversy came to light after claims of irregularities in donation counting surfaced on social media, following which the organisation Bhairav Sena sought an inquiry and registration of an FIR.

MPOST

Ram Temple

reside in Ayodhya during the tenure.

The Trust has fixed July 18, 4 pm, as the last date for submitting applications. Candidates between 50 and 70 years of age are eligible to apply. Applicants must have a

good command of both Hindi and English.

One of the key eligibility conditions is that the applicant must be a practising Hindu and a Ram devotee belonging to the Vaishnav tradition. The Trust has also made it mandatory for candidates to have at least 20 years of professional experience. Preference will be given to those with experience as a senior administrative officer or in managing Hindu religious institutions.

The recruitment follows the Trust's decision to overhaul administrative arrangements after the exposure of the Ram Temple donation theft case. On Sunday, Construction Committee Chairman Nripendra Misra described the incident as "a blot" and said it had made everyone associated with the temple "feel small," adding that the Trust must ensure such incidents are never repeated.

A three-member committee constituted by the Trust will scrutinise applications and select the new CEO.

The notification said the CEO will be responsible for the overall administration and management of the temple and will oversee its day-to-day functioning in accordance with the Trust's objectives and policies. The detailed responsibilities have also been outlined in the notification issued by the Trust.

Retail inflation

2026-27 to 5.1 per cent from 4.6 per cent. The revision reflected rising input costs following the impact of higher global energy prices on domestic petrol and diesel rates. The Monetary Policy Committee will hold its next meeting from August 3 to 5.

Market economists said inflation could rise further in the coming months but is still expected to remain within the RBI's tolerance limit. They pointed to higher food prices, global crude oil volatility, geopolitical tensions and weather conditions as the main risks, while adding that the central bank is likely to keep interest rates unchanged in August unless these factors worsen.

Analysts also noted that both food and non-food categories contributed to the June increase, with fuel-related costs playing a larger role after the rise in petrol and diesel prices. They said easing crude prices have lowered the chances of an immediate rate hike, although developments in West Asia, the progress of the monsoon, currency movements and liquidity conditions will remain important for future policy decisions.

The NSO compiles retail inflation data using real-time price information collected from 1,407 urban markets, including online platforms, and 1,465 villages across all states and Union Territories.

SC asks Centre

It concerns policy issues which need technological advancement and expert consideration," the bench observed.

The court said such matters fall within the jurisdiction of experts and the concerned ministry rather than the judiciary. It directed that the petition be forwarded to the appropriate government authority, saying it had "no reason to doubt" that the concerns would receive due attention.

During the hearing, Thakur

argued that unrestricted access to pornographic content was causing psychological distress among minors and contributing to sexual offences. He also pointed to what he described as a gap in the Information Technology Act, 2000. While the law criminalises the publication and transmission of obscene material, it does not penalise the act of viewing such content, making regulation difficult, he argued.

Responding to the submissions, the bench remarked, "You want to bring the moon on earth that we cannot do," before disposing of the petition.

The plea said children have been increasingly exposed to internet-enabled devices since the Covid-19 pandemic, when education shifted online, and claimed there is no effective mechanism to prevent minors from accessing pornography.

Citing internet pornography statistics, the petition claimed around 5,000 porn sites are viewed every second and more than two crore porn videos or clips are uploaded online each year. It also referred to Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, which empowers authorities to block public access to online information, arguing that the existing powers have not been sufficiently effective in tackling the spread of pornographic content.

SC flags

"How can the State prevent the elopement of a girl and a boy? POCOS is sexual assault and exploitation of children," the bench said, adding that the 15 to 18 age group is vulnerable. "It's the age of experimentation. The question is, does it really become a POCOS case?"

The proceedings stem from a 2023 Calcutta High Court judgment that advised adolescent girls to "control" their sexual urges instead of entering relationships. The Supreme Court set aside that ruling in 2024 after taking suo motu cognisance of the issue and issuing several directions.

Senior advocate Madhavi Divan told the court that the case originated from the elopement of a minor with a 25-year-old man. She said a court-appointed committee later interacted with the woman and submitted a report pointing to systemic failures in handling POCOS cases. She also said minors are entitled to rehabilitation measures under the law.

When the bench asked whether it was a case of elopement or kidnapping, Divan replied that the woman had chosen to stay with the man and the couple now had a child. The bench noted that teenagers aged 16 to 18 often enter relationships voluntarily, but parents frequently invoke criminal law. Divan argued that the law was being misused, resulting in teenagers being jailed under POCOS despite consensual relationships.

The court observed that such relationships existed even before the age of consent was raised from 16 to 18 in 2012, making them illegal under the revised law. It said any directions issued by the court must remain practical. The matter will next be heard on July 17. The Centre informed the court that it had made recommendations for implementation across states and Union Territories, while Divan suggested creating a dashboard to monitor POCOS cases. The bench said existing child rights committees in high courts and state governments could oversee such monitoring.

MLA POACHING CHARGES

BJP sends legal notice to J&K CM Omar

MPOST BUREAU

SRINAGAR: Over the past week, the political arena in Jammu and Kashmir has witnessed charges and counter-charges on the issue of poaching of ruling National Conference (NC) MLAs even as the Chief Minister Omar Abdullah has heightened the pitch for demanding statehood to Jammu and Kahmir.

As Omar Abdullah vowed to take protest to Delhi for the demand of statehood to the Union Territory, he also accused the BJP of trying to lure NC legislators in a bid to topple his government. Reacting swiftly and terming the charges false, the BJP sent a legal notice to the chief minister.

Abdullah on Monday said he feels honoured to have received a “love letter” in the form of a legal notice from the BJP as it proves that he is a political force they cannot ignore.

The BJP’s Jammu and Kashmir unit served a legal notice to Abdullah over his claim that the



Omar Abdullah

party had attempted to bribe NC legislators with cash and ministerial berths in a bid to topple his government.

“I have received a letter from a lawyer, an electronic copy. I consider this a great honour as I am the only politician in Jammu and Kashmir to have been bestowed with a love letter like this by the BJP. I consider it a mark of respect that I am obviously a political force in Jammu and Kashmir that they cannot ignore,” Abdullah told reporters at the National

Highlights

» Abdullah said he feels honoured to have received a ‘love letter’ in the form of a legal notice from BJP

» J&K CM said he was expecting a political response from the BJP since he had made a political statement, however, they chose the legal route

Conference (NC) headquarters here.

He was responding to a question about the BJP’s legal notice to him, threatening a Rs 100 crore defamation suit if he fails to prove the allegations of MLA poaching or issue a public apology.

Abdullah said he was expecting a political response from the BJP since he had made a political statement; however, they chose the legal route.

“It is symbolic of the way the BJP fights. They take politi-

cal fights and hide behind the courts. I could have made the same statement and hid behind the Assembly. I could have taken advantage of the privileges afforded to me by making the statements in the Assembly which cannot be challenged outside the Assembly, but I did not,” he said.

Abdullah noted that several BJP leaders from Jammu and Kashmir have made slanderous accusations against the NC and its leadership over the past few months. The BJP asserted that the allegations amount to defamation under both civil and criminal law and calls upon the chief minister to withdraw his charges in writing and demands an unconditional public apology.

The party has termed the allegations of MLA poaching “false, baseless and defamatory”.

Omar Abdullah , while addressing NC workers at Hazratbal last week, alleged that the BJP is trying to bring down his government by engineering a split in his party. He also claimed that an NC MLA from

Jammu told him that he was offered Rs 20-30 crore and a ministerial berth to switch sides to the saffron camp.

He announced on Sunday that the NC would launch a fresh phase of its campaign for the restoration of statehood, with a protest in New Delhi on July 20 after what he described as nearly two years of waiting for the Centre to fulfil its promise.

Addressing a large public rally at Maharaja Hari Singh Park in Jammu city, Abdullah said the party had exhausted its patience and would now intensify its movement by taking the demand directly to the national capital.

“Enough is enough! There will be no more waiting!” Abdullah declared before a large gathering of party workers. The rally came a day after the NC held a workers’ convention at the mausoleum of Abdullah’s grandparents in the Hazratbal area to mark the 26th death anniversary of his grandmother, Akbar Jehan.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

VIETNAM BOAT TRAGEDY

Flight carrying bodies of 15 Indians killed lands at Mumbai airport

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: A flight carrying the bodies of 15 Indian nationals killed in a boat tragedy in Vietnam last week has landed at the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport in Mumbai.

The Vietnam Airlines flight VN 979 from Ho Chi Minh City landed at 9.19 pm on Monday, sources said.

Of the 15 victims, 10 were from Tamil Nadu, three were from Andhra Pradesh, and two were from Kerala. Two of the deceased were women.

The bodies will be flown to Coimbatore, Chennai, Hyderabad and Trivandrum, the sources said.

A speedboat carrying 32 Indian tourists and four local crew members capsized near Hon May Rut Ngoai off Phu Quoc Island on Friday, killing 15 Indian tourists.

Sixteen others were rescued and have returned to India after receiving medical treatment,



Rescue personnel carry out operations after a speedboat carrying Indian tourists capsized near Hon May Rut Ngoai off Phu Quoc Island, Vietnam, on Saturday. 15 Indian tourists were killed and 16 others rescued in the accident.

PTI

while one survivor remains in critical condition at a hospital in Phu Quoc.

The tourists were reportedly returning from an island visit when the speedboat capsized about 400 metres off Hon May Rut Ngoai island.

Meanwhile, Andhra Pradesh MSME Minister Kondapalli Srinivas on Monday said the mortal remains of the

three Andhra Pradesh tourists who died in the Vietnam boat tragedy were expected to reach Hyderabad on Tuesday morning after completion of statutory formalities in Mumbai.

A total of 20 tourists from Andhra Pradesh and Telangana who survived the Vietnam boat tragedy arrived in Hyderabad on a flight late on Sunday after being repatriated from Vietnam.

Govt silent on corruption in education, alleges Rahul Gandhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Ahead of his second interaction with students under the ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ initiative, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Monday said India’s education system has now become a “dishonest extortion mechanism” and asserted that now it is time for a revolution in this sector.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha also alleged that in the face of corruption in the education system, the Modi government and Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan have chosen silence, turning their face away from accountability.

In a post in Hindi on X, Gandhi said, “Corrupt, unjust,

‘System that was meant to prepare children for their future is pushing them and their families into debt, stress and despair’

biased, dishonest – these four words are not mine, these are what the country’s students are using today for India’s education system. And the truth is – India’s education system has now become a dishonest extortion mechanism.”

The system that was meant to prepare children for their future is today pushing them

and their families into debt, stress and despair, the former Congress chief said.

“It is this corruption that has given birth to the paper leak mafia, which robs years of hard work from millions of preparing students in one fell swoop. Here, guilty vendors and officials get tenders and promotions. And who gets the punishment? The students, who are left alone with their shattered dreams,” Gandhi said.

“The Modi government and the education minister are watching all this. But they have chosen silence – turning their face away from accountability. And the media? Just a long silence. Enough is enough – now is the time for a revolution in education,” Gandhi said.

Parties oppose SC mediation move in Gyanvapi, Mathura & Sambhal temple-mosque disputes

VARANASI/MATHURA/ SAMBHAL: Efforts to explore an out-of-court settlement in three major religious site disputes in Uttar Pradesh have failed to gain traction, with parties in the Gyanvapi, Sri Krishna Janmabhoomi-Shahi Eidgah and the Sambhal Shahi Jama Masjid cases insisting that the courts adjudicate the matter.

The Supreme Court has launched the ‘Supreme Court Action for Mediated Adjudication and Disputes Harmonisation Across Nation’ (SAMADHAN SAMAROH) to encourage amicable settlement of pending cases through mediation ahead of a Special Lok Adalat scheduled to be held on August 21, 22 and 23.



As part of the initiative, parties in several pending matters have been asked to explore the possibility of an amicable settlement.

In the Gyanvapi case, Hindu side counsel Madan Mohan Yadav said the Supreme Court had asked both parties

Committee secretary Mohammad Yasin said thousands of similar disputes were pending across the country and doubted whether mediation would lead to any resolution.

He said the committee was still considering whether to participate in the mediation process. The Gyanvapi issue in Varanasi is an ongoing civil court case involving conflicting claims over the religious status of Gyanvapi mosque, which lies adjacent to the Kashi Vishwanath Temple.

The Hindu side claims that the mosque was built after Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb destroyed parts of the ancient temple in the 17th century.

MPOST

BJP, RSS turned temples into ‘collection centres’, alleges Khara

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Senior Congress leader Pawan Khara on Monday accused the BJP and the RSS of turning temples into “collection centres” for the Sangh. Referring to the reported theft of devotees’ offerings at the Ayodhya Ram temple, he alleged that it reflected a “business model of theft” built

around faith. Addressing a press conference at the KPCC headquarters here, Khara said the Congress was raising the issue on behalf of millions of devotees who had donated their hard-earned money, jewellery and valuables for the construction of the Ram temple and as offerings to the deity.

MPOST

EC has unleashed chaos, absolute mayhem: Cong

NEW DELHI: Criticising the Election Commission for the manner in which it was conducting the SIR, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh on Monday said the poll watchdog has unleashed “chaos and absolute mayhem” that is sparing nobody.

The Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh shared on X an article by RS Sharma, former director general of the Unique Identification Authority of India, in which he stated that asking people to prove citizenship is state’s failure.

In his post, Ramesh said, “This is a powerful and courageous article by a very distinguished former civil servant

with a background in science and technology.”

“The Election Commission has unleashed chaos and absolute mayhem that is sparing nobody,” the Congress leader said. The Congress last week had alleged that the Election Commission is functioning as an “arm of the BJP” and claimed that the SIR was part of the “Modi-Shah strategy” to “manufacture a majority” by manipulating the electoral rolls.

Ramesh had asserted that nobody is against the process of electoral roll revision but what is being opposed is the manner in which the Election Commission (EC) is “managing, coordinating, and manipulating” the entire process.

MPOST

SC stays Madras HC order banning cow slaughter in Tamil Nadu

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday stayed the Madras High Court order which directed the Tamil Nadu government to ensure that no cow or calf is slaughtered in the state.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta passed the order while hearing a plea filed by the state government challenging a May 27 order of the high court.

The state government termed the order contrary to the Tamil Nadu Animal Preservation Act, 1958. The Act permits the slaughter of cows aged over 10 years that are unfit for work and breeding, on the basis of a certificate issued by a competent authority.

The apex court agreed to

A bench passed order while hearing a plea filed by state govt challenging a May 27 order of HC

hear the matter and issued notice to the respondents, including the one on whose plea the high court had passed the order, seeking their replies.

During the hearing, the bench orally observed that the last paragraph of the high court order prima facie required correction.

In that paragraph, the high court had said, “We allow this

writ petition with a direction to the state of Tamil Nadu to ensure that no cow or calf is slaughtered on the eve of Bakrid or on any other day.”

The high court had also said that authorities, particularly the chief secretary and the additional director general of police (law and order), are obliged to issue suitable instructions to all officials concerned to ensure that there is no breach of this order.

The Tamil Nadu government challenged the May 27 order of the high court, which directed the state authorities to ensure that no cow or calf is slaughtered in the state either on the eve of Bakrid on May 28 this year or on any other day.

MPOST

NCSC resolved historic 60,000 cases nationally in last two years: Scheduled Caste commission chief

Makwana stated that NCSC offices across the states are firmly dedicated to ensuring justice and protecting the rights of deprived and marginalised communities

OUR CORRESPONDENT

HYDERABAD: NCSC Chairman Kishor Makwana on Monday said the National Commission for Scheduled Castes has resolved a historic 60,000 cases nationally in the last two years.

Speaking after inaugurating the renovated State Office of the NCSC here, Makwana stated that NCSC offices across the states are firmly dedicated to ensuring justice and protecting the rights of deprived and marginalised communities, an official release said.

Invoking the constitutional mandate under Article 338 and the core vision of B R Ambedkar, he said: “The Commission has been working tirelessly for 75 years to safeguard the rights of Scheduled Castes and address public grievances.”

Highlighting a significant surge in public trust, he noted

Key Points

» Invoking the constitutional mandate under Article 338 and the core vision of B R Ambedkar, he said: ‘The Commission has been working tirelessly for 75 years to safeguard the rights of Scheduled Castes and address public grievances’

» Highlighting a significant surge in public trust, he noted that more than 60,000 cases were resolved nationally over the last two years—marking the highest disposal rate in the Commission’s history

» Speaking on the occasion, Member of NCSC, Vaddepalli Ramchander, highlighted the powerful statutory mechanisms vested in the Commission to ensure accountability

» Earlier, in his address, Secretary of NCSC, Gudey Srinivas, emphasised the Commission’s commitment to utilising digital tools and modern infrastructure to eliminate delays and enhance the overall efficiency of grievance resolution

that more than 60,000 cases were resolved nationally over the last two years—marking the highest disposal rate in the Commission’s history.

He reaffirmed the Commission’s unwavering commitment to realising Dr Ambedkar’s dream by ensuring timely justice for every petitioner.

Speaking on the occasion, Member of NCSC, Vaddepalli Ramchander, highlighted the

powerful statutory mechanisms vested in the Commission to ensure accountability.

He reiterated that the NCSC is fully empowered to issue notices, execute summons, and initiate stringent action against non-compliance when required.

Expressing concern over the current state of financial support for SC entrepreneurs, he urged elected

representatives and policymakers to prioritise MSME development and welfare measures for marginalised communities, assuring entrepreneurs of the Commission’s continued support in addressing their grievances and promoting inclusive growth.

Earlier, in his address, Secretary of NCSC, Gudey Srinivas, emphasised the Commission’s commitment

to utilising digital tools and modern infrastructure to eliminate delays and enhance the overall efficiency of grievance resolution.

Meanwhile, Makwana met Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy here, a release from the CMO said.

During the meeting, the CM briefed him about the opportunities provided for the socio-economic and political empowerment of the SC communities. Implementation of the SC categorisation was discussed in the meeting, it said.

Revanth Reddy said that the state government was taking a slew of measures to eliminate caste discrimination among students.

The CM asserted that the union government should take initiatives to provide necessary support and cooperation for the development of SCs, the release added.

BSES

BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE Date: 14.07.2026

Sealed bids are invited from interested bidders under “Single Stage: Two Envelope” bidding basis for the following Materials:-

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/FK/CR/SL/1373	ENGAGEMENT OF CONSULTANT FOR PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT OFFICE (PMO) SUPPORT SERVICES	2 Lacs	27.07.2026 15:00 HRS	27.07.2026 15:30 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹ 1180/- (Non Refundable)
For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submiton of tender documents etc. please visit our website www.bsesdelhi.com **Head (Contracts & Materials)**
Regd. Off. : BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111627
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsesdelhi.com

M.P. ROAD DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.
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45-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal – 462 011, Madhya Pradesh, Ph. No. : 0755-2527290/
2765205, Fax : (EPBX) 0755-2572643, Website : www.mprdc.gov.in
NIT No.712/MPRDC/Procu/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

Madhya Pradesh Road Development Corporation Limited (MPRDC) Bhopal invites online tenders for the following works.

S. No.	Name of Work	APC/ PAC Value (in INR Lacs)	Bid Security (EMD) (in INR Lacs)	Cost of Tender Document (i/c GST) (in Rs.)	Period of Contract/ Completion
1.	User Fee Collection on Bhopal Bypass Road in the State of Madhya Pradesh	7272.50	363.62	59,000/-	24 Months
2.	Implementation (Supply, Installation, Integration & Operation and Maintenance) of Hybrid ETC System at Various Toll Plazas of MPRDC in the State of MP Package– A (2nd Call)	837.79	8.38	23,600/-	60 days
3.	Renewal and Maintenance work on Manawar- Singhana- Kukshi Road	772.43	7.72	23,600/-	06 Months (Including Rainy season)
4.	B.T. Renewal work at Pipariya-Matkuli SH-62 (km. 109-114, 116, 117) and Matkuli-Pachmadhi SH-41A (km. 24 to 28) road Total length - 13.00 km. (2nd Call)	304.52	3.05	17,700/-	03 Months (Excluding Rainy Seasons)
5.	Photocopy and Spiral Binding Work for MPRDC, Bhopal.	10.14	0.20	2,360/-	24 Months

The dates for purchase, submission, etc. are mentioned in the key dates. Tender forms can be purchased online only upto **15:30 hrs. on 18.08.2026 for Sr. No. 1, 3 & 5 and 11.08.2026 for Sr. No. 2 & 4** from website www.mptenders.gov.in. The bidders have to submit the **Technical bid as well as Financial Bid online only**. The Addendum/Corrigendum (if any) shall only be published on the website of www.mptenders.gov.in only. If holiday is declared by Govt. of M.P. on the date of opening, the same will automatically be shifted to subsequent working days. MPRDC reserves the right to accept/reject any/all tenders without assigning any reason thereof.
M.P. Madhyam/126835/2026

MANAGING DIRECTOR

DEFENCE INDUSTRIAL COLLABORATION & CYBER SECURITY IN FOCUS

India, Japan eye deeper ties in emerging domains

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India and Japan, at a key bilateral meeting in Tokyo on Monday, discussed ways to deepen cooperation in emerging domains, including defence industrial collaboration, technological innovation, cyber security, space and other areas of shared strategic interest, officials said.

Both sides also expressed satisfaction with the 'growing convergence' between the two countries on regional and global security issues, and agreed to continue working closely in the Indo-Pacific, reiterating their commitment to promoting a free, open and rules-based Indo-Pacific region "founded on respect for international law".

The two sides held their eighth Defence Policy Dia-



Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, right, and Japan's Vice Minister of Defence for International Affairs, Kano Koji, during the 8th India-Japan Defence Policy Dialogue, in Tokyo, Japan

logue in Tokyo on Monday, India's defence ministry said in a statement.

The Indian delegation was led by Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, while the Japanese delegation was led by Vice Minister of Defence for International Affairs, Kano Koji.

The two countries held comprehensive discussions on the prevailing regional and global security environment and exchanged views on issues of mutual interest, the statement said.

"The dialogue reviewed the entire spectrum of bilateral defence engagements,

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The two sides held their eighth Defence Policy Dialogue in Tokyo on Monday
- » Both sides also expressed satisfaction with the 'growing convergence' between the two countries on regional and global security issues
- » The two countries also exchanged views on issues of mutual interest

including military-to-military exchanges, cooperation between joint headquarters, maritime cooperation, defence exercises, capacity building, defence equipment and technology cooperation, including maritime technology, and enhanced institutional interactions," it said.

The two delegations also discussed ways to deepen cooperation in emerging domains, including defence industrial collaboration, technological innovation, cyber security, space, and other areas of shared strategic interest, the officials said.

The key meeting followed soon after Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's visit to India from July 1 to 3 for the 16th India-Japan annual summit.

It was Takaichi's first official visit to India.

During the meeting in Tokyo, both sides also reviewed the significant progress made in bilateral defence cooperation since the previous Defence Policy Dialogue, and reaffirmed their commitment to further strengthening the India-Japan Special Strategic and Global

Partnership, the officials said.

Both sides welcomed the "steady expansion" of defence cooperation and underscored the importance of maintaining regular high-level exchanges and dialogue mechanisms.

"They discussed the probable outcomes of the forthcoming ministerial visits, including 2+2, later this year," the defence ministry said.

Defence Secretary Singh appreciated Japan's continued engagement with India in the defence sector and highlighted the importance of strengthening practical cooperation under the framework of the India-Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership.

Kano Koji reaffirmed Japan's commitment to further expanding defence ties with India across priority areas, the officials said.

Sonam Wangchuk loses over 8 kg as fast enters 16th day

'Lives at stake', says Abhijeet Dipke



Sonam Wangchuk being assisted by a medical professional and CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke during the hunger strike

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Educator and climate activist Sonam Wangchuk has lost 8.2 kg since his indefinite hunger strike at the Jantar Mantar began, and his blood glucose level has dropped to 67 mg/dL, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) said on Monday, with its founder Abhijeet Dipke urging the Centre to address the protesters' demands as "lives are at stake".

With Wangchuk's indefinite fast entering Day 16, his health has deteriorated further. According to a health update shared by CJP, Wangchuk's blood pressure was recorded at 107/70 mm Hg. His total weight loss since the beginning of the hunger strike has reached 8.2 kg.

The CJP protest at Jantar Mantar over alleged examination irregularities entered Day 24 on Monday.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke appealed to the Centre not to turn the issue into "a battle of egos" and urged it to address the protesters' demands.

"Day 16 of Wangchuk's hunger strike. I request the government not to turn this into a battle of egos as human lives are at stake here," Dipke said in a post on X.

"Acknowledging a mistake is not a sign of weakness. It is a sign of maturity, accountability, and the willingness to correct course. All we are asking for is accountability," he added.

On the day, an AAP delegation led by former Delhi chief minister Atishi visited the protest site and expressed solidarity with the agitation, according to the CJP.

CPI(M) MP Amra Ram, along with senior CPI(M) leaders from Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan, also visited the protest site and backed the demands. The visiting leaders also extended support to the proposed peaceful march from Jantar Mantar to Parliament on July 20.

According to the CJP, the AAP delegation reiterated its support for the movement, demanded a transparent, fair and credible examination system and backed the demand for Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation.

Members of the CPI(ML) Liberation-affiliated All India Students' Association (AISA) -- Neha, Manish, Deepak and Aameen -- continued their indefinite hunger strike on a separate stage at the protest site.

CM ORDERS REFUND OF EXCESS CHARGES

Punjab caps private school fee hike at 5%



Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann addresses a press conference

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Monday announced that private schools that increased fees by more than five per cent annually during the last three years will have to refund the excess amount to parents, asserting that educational institutions would not be allowed to become "profit-making factories".

Addressing a press conference, Mann said Governor Gulab Chand Kataria has approved the Punjab Regulation of Fee of Unaided Educational Institutions (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026, which came into effect immediately on Monday.

Under the ordinance, a regulatory committee headed by Deputy Commissioners will scrutinise fee hikes by

private schools. Schools that raised fees by more than 15 per cent over the past three years will be required to refund the excess amount collected from parents.

"For instance, if a school increased fees by 25 per cent during the last three years, it will have to refund the excess 10 per cent," Mann said, adding that schools would not be allowed to adjust the excess amount against future fees

Schools that raised fees by more than 15% over the past 3 years will be required to refund the excess amount

and would have to make actual refunds.

The chief minister said the five per cent annual cap would cover tuition fees as well as all mandatory charges and funds collected by schools, including transport and other fees. A clear definition of "fees" has been incorporated in the ordinance to prevent institutions from circumventing the provisions.

Schools have been

directed to furnish fee records of the past four years within ten days and upload the details on the Education Department's portal within a month.

Mann said schools violating the provisions would face penalties ranging from Rs 50,000 to Rs 1 lakh, and repeated violations could lead to cancellation of affiliation.

Stating that education had increasingly become a business, Mann said many parents had complained about arbitrary fee hikes and harassment over pending dues. He referred to the recent suicide of a 17-year-old student in Amritsar, allegedly after being harassed over unpaid fees, saying the incident prompted the government to act.

Around 81L women removed from Maharashtra's 'Ladki Bahin' scheme

CAG flags Rs 3,541 crore excess spend, budgetary lapses

MUMBAI: Around 81 lakh registered beneficiaries have been removed from Maharashtra government's Ladki Bahin Yojana following a multi-month e-KYC verification drive, minister Aditi Tatkare said on Monday, while the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has flagged financial irregularities and excess spending in the implementation of the state's flagship welfare scheme.

Speaking to reporters, the Women and Child Development minister clarified that the e-KYC process was mandatory to systematically weed out ineligible registrations, who are not covered under the scheme. "When the scheme was launched, 2.63 crore persons had registered to avail its benefits, and of them, 2.47 crore women became beneficiaries and received monthly financial assistance. Once the department started e-KYC to filter out non-eligible beneficiaries, the number started shrinking further," she said.

About media reports claiming removal of 93 lakh beneficiaries, Tatkare said: "After the

e-KYC drive, the number of beneficiaries had reached 1.67 to 1.7 crore. If you subtract this figure from the number of people who had registered for the scheme at the time of its launch, you get 92 to 93 lakh. But in reality, the state disbursed the stipend to 2.47 crore women, and the rest were found to be ineligible right from the start."

She stated that around 62 lakh women who had registered for the scheme and received benefits did not complete the e-KYC process despite repeated extensions.

"Around 16 lakh beneficiaries were found to have annual family income exceeding Rs 2.5 lakh, while 4.42 lakh were declared ineligible because a family member was a government employee," she said, adding that even some men and government employees had registered for the scheme and received benefits.

Separately, the CAG's State Finances Audit Report 2024-25, tabled in the Maharashtra legislature on Friday, raised concerns over the financial management of the scheme. It

reported that the Women and Child Development Department spent Rs 33,237.24 crore against an authorised budget of Rs 29,693.09 crore, resulting in excess expenditure of Rs 3,541.16 crore without any specific justification.

The audit noted that the total allocation included Rs 26,200 crore through supplementary provisions and Rs 3,490.75 crore reappropriated from the Lek Ladki Yojana. It also found that Rs 15,586 crore withdrawn between January and March 2025 was transferred to Virtual Personal Deposit Accounts (VPDAs).

Calling the practice a "serious financial irregularity", the CAG said parking funds in VPDAs without immediate expenditure requirements violated principles of budgetary discipline and financial propriety. It also observed deficiencies in budget estimation, expenditure control and financial management, and recommended realistic assessment of beneficiary numbers and fund requirements for large Direct Benefit Transfer schemes.

AMRUT 2.0: MoHUA 'steps up' groundwater recharge measures

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) has stepped up water conservation and groundwater recharge measures across the country under the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT) 2.0, in line with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of "Catch the Rain - Where it Falls, When it Falls".

According to the ministry, rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge and sustainable water management initiatives are being implemented in mission mode by 27 States and Union Territories and around 900 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).

As part of efforts to create sustainable urban settlements, various initiatives are being undertaken to replenish groundwater aquifers through rainwater harvesting and arti-

Rainwater harvesting initiatives are being implemented in a 'mission mode'

ficial recharge structures to meet the growing water needs of urban areas.

Under the Jal Shakti Abhiyan-Jan Bhagidari (JSJB) 2.0 convergence scheme with MoHUA, around 1.99 lakh recharge structures are being developed in 79 municipal corporations. In addition, another 73,036 recharge structures are being taken up in 738 ULBs, significantly boosting groundwater recharge capacity.

The ministry said the Shallow Aquifer Management (SAM) programme under AMRUT 2.0 has shown encouraging results through scientific interventions based on ground-

water and aquifer mapping. Burdwan in West Bengal has developed recharge pits with injection bore wells, while Itanagar in Arunachal Pradesh has adopted rooftop rainwater harvesting with recharge structures.

Similar interventions have also been undertaken in Korba district of Chhattisgarh and Warangal in Telangana to augment groundwater reserves ahead of the monsoon.

Under the Water Body Rejuvenation component of AMRUT 2.0, nearly 1.21 lakh acres of water bodies are being rejuvenated through de-silting, deepening, shoreline protection and biodiversity enhancement measures. The ministry said these efforts would help arrest groundwater depletion, reduce urban flooding and contribute to climate change mitigation.

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has conducted searches at 19 locations across Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Jammu and Kashmir in connection with a money laundering probe linked to a fake online investment and "work-from-home" scam, seizing crypto assets worth Rs 3.35 crore and attaching other assets.

The searches were carried out by the ED's Chennai Zonal Office under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) on July 10 and 11. Of the 19 locations searched, 16 were in Tamil Nadu, two in Kerala and one in Srinagar.

According to the agency, the probe stems from FIRs registered by the Tamil Nadu and Telangana Police in cases related to fraudulent invest-

Haryana CM Saini orders timely completion of all govt projects

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday directed officials to ensure the timely completion of all government projects and warned against extending implementation deadlines, saying delays escalate costs and deprive people of benefits.

Chairing the State PRAGATI Project Review Meeting, Saini reviewed 12 projects worth more than Rs 75 crore and issued directions to the concerned departments. He said the government is committed to completing projects within the stipulated timeframe and stressed that any delay places an additional financial burden on the exchequer.

Reviewing the Apple Market at Pinjore and the International Fruits, Flowers,



Vegetables and Horticulture Market at Ganaur, Saini directed officials to install solar power systems to make the mandis self-reliant in electricity. He said three air-conditioned sheds have already been constructed and around 20 per cent of the area would be developed as green space.

He also directed officials to arrange a Ranney well, light and sound systems and rainwater harvesting facilities, saying the mandi would emerge

as one of North India's most modern agricultural markets and benefit farmers from several states. Saini instructed officials to expedite the expansion of BharatNet services, stating that optical fibre connectivity to 5,200 Gram Panchayats is in the final stage, while nearly 1,000 more panchayats will soon be covered.

Among other projects, he said a seven-storey, 100-bed hospital would be constructed in Nuh at a cost of around Rs 156 crore, while infrastructure projects worth Rs 153 crore are being developed at Lala Lajpat Rai University of Veterinary and Animal Sciences in Hisar.

The CM also reviewed the Rs 707-crore Integrated Manufacturing Cluster in Hisar and the Rs 1,003-crore Global City Project in Gurugram.

'BLATANT MISAPPROPRIATION OF PUBLIC FUNDS'

CAG: Maha's 'ghost hostels' received Rs 1.62-cr govt funding in four years

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Dilapidated, locked buildings and dust-covered, empty beds. The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has unmasked six "ghost hostels" in Maharashtra that quietly received Rs 1.62 crore in government funds over four years without housing a single student.

The CAG's compliance audit report 2024, tabled in the state legislature on July 10, highlighted serious deficiencies in infrastructure, safety, hygiene and financial management in government-run and aided hostels meant for students from backward and economically weaker sections.

"The Department of Social Justice and Special Assistance disbursed Rs 1.62 crore to non-functional entities over four years," the CAG report stated, describing the six institutions as "ghost hostels" and pointing to a blatant misappropriation of public funds.

As of March 2024, Maharashtra had 443 gov-

INSIGHT

- » The auditor also flagged widespread shortcomings in govt hostels, saying many lacked dining halls, libraries, computer laboratories, CCTV surveillance, TVs, and power backup
- » The report criticised the administration over the



poor use of funds, noting that Rs 56.65 cr out of the Rs 487 cr allocated for govt hostels in 2023-24 remained unspent

ernment-run and 2,388 government-aided hostels catering to 1,21,971 boys and 40,543 girls. The state spent Rs 2,321 crore on these hostels during the audit period. The CAG's audit covered physical inspection of 18 government-run and 21 government-aided hostels.

The report cited Modikhan Hostel in Jalna as one of the fraudulent institutions, noting that the building was dilapidated and locked with no signs of occupancy, though the records showed 38 students and a superintendent.

It noted that the state gov-

ernment continued to release Rs 18 lakh in honorariums to the hostel over four years.

As per the report, the CAG team found dusty beds with no occupants at a hostel, built for 24 students in Jafrabad (Jalna), and had uncovered similar "ghost" hostels at four in Jalna, and one each in Buldhana and Latur. The auditor also flagged widespread shortcomings in government hostels, saying many lacked dining halls, libraries, computer laboratories, CCTV surveillance, daily newspapers, televisions and power backup.



EDITORIAL

PROTECTION OR PUNISHMENT?

The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act was enacted with an unequivocal purpose: to shield children from sexual abuse, exploitation and predatory behaviour. It was designed as one of India's strongest child-protection laws, closing legal loopholes and ensuring that crimes against minors were prosecuted swiftly and sensitively. More than a decade later, however, an uncomfortable question has begun to surface with increasing frequency. Can a law meant to protect children sometimes end up criminalising them? The Supreme Court's recent observations on the misuse of POCSO provisions in cases involving consensual adolescent relationships deserve careful attention because they expose a growing disconnect between legislative intent and social reality. The Court's remarks—that parents often invoke POCSO after teenage couples elope to preserve family honour, and that adolescence is “the age of experimentation”—do not diminish the seriousness of child sexual abuse. Instead, they acknowledge a difficult truth: not every relationship involving minors fits the mould of exploitation that the law was originally designed to address.

The challenge lies in the law's absolute framework. Since the age of consent was raised from 16 to 18 in 2012, every sexual act involving a person below 18 has become an offence regardless of consent. From a legal standpoint, this is understandable. Minors are presumed incapable of giving informed consent because they remain vulnerable to coercion, manipulation and unequal power dynamics. This bright-line rule strengthens prosecution against genuine offenders and avoids ambiguity in cases of abuse. Yet the same framework produces troubling consequences when applied to relationships between two adolescents of similar age who willingly enter into a romantic relationship. Across the country, courts increasingly encounter cases where a teenage girl leaves home with her boyfriend, only for anxious or angry parents to file kidnapping and POCSO charges. The criminal justice system then treats the young man—often himself barely an adult—as a sexual predator. By the time trials conclude, the girl may have repeatedly stated that she acted voluntarily, the couple may even have started a family, and courts ultimately acquit the accused. But years of incarceration, social stigma and emotional trauma cannot be undone by an acquittal.

This is not merely a legal problem; it reflects deeper social tensions. In many communities, adolescent relationships remain taboo. Concerns over caste, religion, family reputation and social honour often overshadow the wishes of young people. Criminal law becomes an instrument through which families attempt to regain control. The Supreme Court's observation that parents sometimes use POCSO to protect their “honour” rather than their children's welfare highlights a reality that many trial courts have quietly witnessed for years. At the same time, the judiciary must guard against creating the impression that all teenage relationships are benign. Adolescence is also a period marked by emotional immaturity, unequal influence and susceptibility to pressure. Significant age differences, grooming, coercion or abuse disguised as romance remain genuine dangers. The law cannot lose sight of these realities while addressing misuse.

The answer, therefore, is not to weaken POCSO but to apply it with greater nuance. Several legal experts have argued for introducing a limited “close-in-age” exemption, often referred to internationally as a “Romeo and Juliet” clause. Such provisions, adopted in various jurisdictions, prevent consensual relationships between teenagers of similar ages from attracting the same criminal liability reserved for adult predators. India must debate whether a carefully drafted version of such an exemption can coexist with robust protections against exploitation. Any reform would require strict safeguards to ensure that adults cannot misuse it to evade prosecution. Equally important is improving investigative practices. Police officers should be trained to distinguish between allegations involving coercion and those arising primarily from parental objections. Prosecutors must examine evidence carefully before invoking the most severe provisions of POCSO. As suggested during the Supreme Court hearing, systematic monitoring of such cases through dedicated dashboards and oversight committees could help identify patterns of misuse and encourage greater accountability.

Beyond legal reform lies an equally pressing need for social and institutional change. Adolescents require accurate sexuality education, mental health support and safe counselling spaces where they can understand relationships, consent and personal responsibility. Schools, parents and communities often avoid conversations about adolescent sexuality, leaving young people to navigate complex emotions without guidance. The result is predictable: secrecy replaces communication, fear replaces trust, and criminal litigation replaces dialogue. The Supreme Court's ongoing examination of adolescent privacy rights recognises that protecting children involves more than punishment. It requires creating environments where young people are informed, supported and treated with dignity. Laws alone cannot resolve questions that are fundamentally social and developmental.

India's child protection framework must remain uncompromising against abuse, trafficking and sexual violence. But it must also recognise that criminal law should not become an instrument for policing adolescent emotions or enforcing family honour. The credibility of POCSO depends not only on its severity but also on its fairness. When courts repeatedly acquit accused persons because prosecutions arose from consensual teenage relationships rather than exploitation, the law risks losing focus on the very children it was enacted to protect. The Supreme Court has opened an important conversation—one that demands sensitivity rather than sensationalism, evidence rather than moral panic, and reform rather than rigidity. Protecting children and respecting adolescent realities are not contradictory objectives. A mature legal system should be capable of doing both.

BHARAT TEX 2026



PABITRA MARGHERITA
THE WRITER IS THE UNION MINISTER OF STATE FOR TEXTILES

The event reflects India's growing role as a global sourcing hub while highlighting policy reforms, sustainability, innovation and the country's long-term ambition to emerge as a leading textile economy

Weaving PM Modi's 5F Vision

As Bharat Tex 2026 opens in New Delhi, India's textile ecosystem showcases heritage, innovation, sustainability and manufacturing strength before the world

From the ethereal warmth of a Kashmiri Pashmina to the majestic lustre of Assam's Muga silk, from the vibrant geometric patterns of a Rajasthani Bandhani to the timeless, structured elegance of Kanjeevaram silk, India's geographic and cultural diversity is a living, breathing map drawn in thread. Today, this unparalleled civilizational canvas is assembled under a single, unified roof. As Bharat Tex 2026 opens its doors at the iconic Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, running from July 14th to 17th, it brings the beautiful diversity of our nation into a single place.

Textiles are not merely a reflection of our heritage; they are an absolute bedrock of India's macroeconomic architecture. The sector remains a monumental engine of growth and equity, contributing 2.3% to GDP, 13% to industrial production, and 8.6% to exports. As India's second-largest employer after agriculture, it sustains over 100 million, strengthening rural communities and driving financial autonomy for millions of women nationwide.

To truly appreciate this economic powerhouse, one must experience Bharat Tex. It is India's definitive, global-scale textile trade fair, designed to showcase our absolute manufacturing and creative dominance to the entire world. It serves as a comprehensive marketplace that brings together domestic manufacturers, state pavilions, international exhibitors, and global buyers under a single roof, enabling high-value sourcing, corporate engagement, and brand showcasing at an unprecedented scale.

Reflecting on the journey of this grand initiative, I am reminded of the immense pride and clarity brought by the previous two editions of Bharat Tex. When Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressed the textile community during the last edition of Bharat Tex, he beautifully observed that the seed we planted is now rapidly growing into a banyan tree. He noted that this grand showcase not only celebrates our rich traditions but also highlights the immense possibilities of a developed India. The massive success of



Bharat Tex is more than a trade exhibition—it is a statement of India's confidence

the first two editions, which attracted unprecedented international buyers and generated massive collaborative momentum, laid a formidable foundation. My personal experience during Bharat Tex 2025, witnessing intensive government-to-government and business-to-government dialogues translated into tangible outcomes, confirmed a highly positive outlook for the future and demonstrated growing global trust in India's execution capabilities. This third edition takes that momentum significantly further, translating early potential into absolute industrial dominance.

The incredible scale of this year's event represents a calculated industrial strategy. Spanning an immense footprint across dedicated exhibition halls at Bharat Mandapam, the exhibition presents India's complete textile value chain, including fibre, yarn, fabric, apparel and fashion, home textiles, technical textiles, and ancillary industries. Over 1,600 exhibitors are participating, bringing localised production strength directly onto the global platform to mirror Prime Minister Modi's transformative 5F Vision: Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign. By integrating the entire value chain into a single industrial continuum, the event showcases India's self-reliant capacity to manage every manufacturing stage natively.

The global response to this proposition has been

remarkable. This edition features international exhibitors from 14 countries including the United States, United Kingdom, Japan, Portugal, Spain, New Zealand, South Korea, South Africa, and Nepal, alongside strong institutional representation from the United Nations and the European Union. Ministerial delegations and high-level business representatives from several countries are participating to explore long-term partnerships. The exhibition is expected to draw over 7,000 buyers from over 110 registered countries and 1.3 lakh trade visitors over the four days, all engaging with more than 20,000 textile products on display. This commercial activity will be anchored by more than 3,500 curated business-to-business meetings, alongside dedicated State Investor Connect Sessions that provide individual Indian states a platform to pitch their distinct industrial infrastructure.

True industrial leadership requires a deep commitment to knowledge and future planning. Bharat Tex 2026 anchors this responsibility through the Global Textile Dialogue, which comprises over 100 curated sessions including panel discussions, roundtables, masterclasses, state sessions, awards pitch fests, and workshops. Led by more than 370 international and national CXOs, policymakers, and innovators, these curated tracks will focus on scaling Trade and Invest-

ment, advancing Technology and Innovation, and elevating Fashion and Craft. The event will also witness the signing and launch of several strategic agreements and sectoral reports across trade, investment, technology, and institutional collaboration.

A significant focus of these deliberations is dedicated to the critical pillar of Sustainability and Circularity. During the previous edition, the Prime Minister highlighted that the global fashion community is increasingly embracing the vision of 'Fashion for Environment' and that sustainability has always been an integral part of Bharat's textile heritage. This edition of Bharat Tex turns global eco-challenges into a massive opportunity, showcasing how cutting-edge innovations evolve our traditional techniques to maximise resource efficiency and eliminate waste, directly benefiting our weavers and artisans. Under the pragmatic leadership of our Minister of Textiles, Shri Giriraj Singh Ji, the Ministry has actively accelerated these modernisation and sustainable growth initiatives on the ground, ensuring that our entire textile value chain is backed by robust modern technology, scalable policy frameworks, and robust market linkages.

The remarkable scale and confidence reflected through Bharat Tex are the direct outcome of a decade of sustained policy reforms under the leadership of Prime Min-

ister Narendra Modi. Over the past 12 years, the Modi Government has strengthened every link of the textile value chain through transformative interventions. The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Textiles has attracted investment commitments of over ₹31,687 crore, catalysing large-scale manufacturing in Man-Made Fibre apparel, fabrics, and technical textiles while generating massive employment. Simultaneously, seven PM MITRA Parks are being developed as integrated manufacturing ecosystems embodying the Prime Minister's visionary 5F approach. Grassroots empowerment remains equally robust; through the National Handloom Development Programme, nearly ₹2,000 crore has been invested across 794 handloom clusters, providing upgraded looms to 1.17 lakh weavers and skill training to around 90,000 workers, while over ₹1,335 crore has been channelled into the handicrafts sector under the National Handicrafts Development Programme. Furthermore, over 1.5 lakh weavers have been onboarded onto the Government e-Marketplace (GeM), with the Weavers' MUDRA Scheme providing collateral-free loans to nearly 3 lakh beneficiaries. By connecting our domestic manufacturers, artisans, and innovators directly with global markets, these comprehensive reforms have structurally prepared us for the massive global step-up we see on display this week.

As we look across the vibrant exhibition halls of Bharat Mandapam, our perspective extends far beyond the immediate horizon of this trade show. This event serves as a critical milestone along our Vision 2030 roadmap to scale India's textile industry into a \$350 billion global powerhouse, a trajectory aligned perfectly with the national goal of Viksit Bharat @ 2047. I invite everyone to join us over these next four days at Bharat Tex 2026 to witness the incredible strength of our workers, the brilliant innovations of our creators, and the future of global textiles, proudly designed, sustainably made, and integrated at scale in India.

Views expressed are personal

STRATEGIC VIEW



ASIF ULLAH KHAN
THE WRITER HAS WORKED IN SENIOR EDITORIAL POSITIONS FOR MANY RENOWNED INTERNATIONAL PUBLICATIONS

If Canada wishes to be taken seriously as a responsible global actor and truly rebuild its partnership with India, it must publicly acknowledge Trudeau's fabrication

The Cost of Accusation

As Ottawa recalibrates ties with New Delhi, the collapse of allegations over the Nijjar case raises difficult questions about political judgment, diplomacy and international credibility

The Canadian government's quiet admission that it has no evidence linking New Delhi to the 2023 assassination of Hardeep Singh Nijjar marks a humiliating collapse of a years-long diplomatic smear campaign.

For nearly three years, former Prime Minister Justin Trudeau weaponised the floor of Canada's Parliament to broadcast “credible allegations” against India, dragging bilateral relations to an absolute nadir. Today, with Trudeau relegated to the political wilderness and US indictments pointing squarely at jailed gangster Lawrence Bishnoi rather than the Indian state, the truth has finally caught up with Ottawa. Trudeau's reckless crusade was never about justice; it was a desperate gamble for political survival that has permanently scarred Canada's international credibility.

From the outset, Trudeau's aggressive posturing against India was driven entirely by domestic vulnerabilities. Leading a fragile minority government, Trudeau's political life support relied heavily on Jagmeet Singh's New Democratic Party (NDP).

To appease a highly vocal, hard-line vote bank, Trudeau chose to compromise Canada's foreign policy, effectively turning Ottawa into a safe haven for extremist elements. By elevating Nijjar — a designated terrorist with a documented history of militancy — to the status of a tragic Canadian martyr, Trudeau chose to pander to a specific domestic audience over maintaining ties with a global superpower.



Diplomatic accusations carry lasting consequences and demand equally compelling evidence

However, political opportunism rarely yields long-term dividends. Canadian voters ultimately rejected Trudeau's divisive politics and economic mismanagement, leading to his resounding defeat. In a poetic twist of democratic fate, the very constituency he sought to appease withdrew its favour; the NDP faced a devastating rout, collapsed under the weight of its own radical rhetoric, and was reduced to just a single parliamentary seat.

The electoral slaughter proved that the vast majority of Canadians, including mainstream Sikh communities, had no appetite for extremism or the diplomatic isolation it brought. Under the new leadership of Prime Minister Mark Carney, Ottawa has signalled a desperate desire to pivot. Recognising the immense economic and strategic cost of Trudeau's alienation of New Delhi, the Carney administration has taken active steps to repair ties and restore normalcy.

The recent RCMP clarifications

and the shifting focus toward criminal syndicates are clear attempts to clear the air. Yet, simply letting the issue quietly fade into the background is not enough.

For real healing to begin, the Canadian government must offer a formal, unconditional apology to India. Ottawa falsely accused a sovereign democratic partner of state-sponsored assassination on the global stage, expelled diplomats, and amplified a narrative that emboldened anti-India extremists. Rectifying a blunder of this magnitude requires more than behind-the-scenes diplomacy or bureaucratic backtracking.

If Canada wishes to be taken seriously as a responsible global actor and truly rebuild its partnership with India, it must publicly acknowledge Trudeau's fabrications, apologise for sheltering entities that threaten India's sovereignty, and officially close this dark chapter of state-sponsored deception.

Views expressed are personal



WHO SAID WHAT

Pawan Khera
@Pawankhera

From the United Nations to the United States, the discriminatory conduct of the Indian government and its compliant institutions is bringing disrepute to our democracy. Hindus are being told that reducing Muslims to second-class citizens will somehow secure their future. The truth is the opposite. The poison of internal discord sown by the BJP – led by its Divider-in-Chief, Narendra Modi – weakens our Republic, shrinks India's global standing, and ultimately harms every Indian, perhaps Hindus most of all. There are many Muslim-majority countries in the world. India is the world's only Hindu-majority nation of comparable global scale and influence. Weakening India's social fabric and consequently, our international standing does not serve Hindu interests. It diminishes us.

AFTER ANOTHER HEAVY EXCHANGE OF FIRE

US and Iran each assert they control the Strait of Hormuz

DUBAI: The United States and Iran each asserted Monday they controlled the Strait of Hormuz after a weekend of attacks across the Middle East, further threatening any diplomacy to end the war.

The latest exchange was sparked by an Iranian attack on a container ship on Sunday in the Strait of Hormuz. Iran has asserted control over the critical waterway for international oil and gas since the United States and Israel started the war on Feb. 28.

Iran says it has the right to manage traffic through the strait and potentially charge fees in accordance with an interim peace deal reached last month. The US and others dispute that, citing international law on freedom of navigation, and the American military has tried to establish an alternative route outside of Iranian control.

Calling into Fox News on Monday, US President Donald Trump said, "we're taking over the Strait." Trump also said that "everything was agreed to" in an 11-hour meeting Sunday, but that Iranian negotiators had called back later and suggested changes. He did not elaborate.

Iran and the US are nearly



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

halfway through the 60-day period in which they were supposed to negotiate a permanent end to the war and an agreement on Iran's disputed nuclear program.

Instead, a series of attacks over the strait have raised fears of a return to all-out war and further disruption to the global economy.

Oil prices jumped nearly

5% on Monday before falling back. US benchmark crude, which had risen to nearly \$120 a barrel at the height of the war, was trading at around \$72.92. Markets were mixed.

US says it has struck dozens of targets in Iran

The US military said it struck dozens of sites in the strikes Monday, including air defense systems, radar sites,

Highlights

- » The latest exchange was sparked by an Iranian attack on a container ship on Sunday in Hormuz
- » Iran says it has the right to manage traffic through the strait and potentially charge fees
- » Oil prices jumped nearly 5% on Monday before falling back

missile and drone equipment, and small boats. It said Iran does not control the Strait of Hormuz. The European Union's top diplomat, Kaja Kallas, called for the strait to be open, as it was before the war. "Freedom of navigation has to be respected," she said. Mohammed Mokhber, an adviser to Iran's supreme leader, wrote that Tehran would fight for the strait. "We defend it so that in the future, for the passage of our ships, we are not forced to pay tribute to the enemy!" he wrote on X. "Retreating from this vital matter has no place in the mind of any friend of Iran." AGENCIES

UK proscribes Iran's IRGC as terror group

LONDON: The UK on Monday announced plans to proscribe Iran's powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) and a second group linked with Tehran over alleged anti-semitic attacks and threats to life on British soil.

Home Office Minister of State for Security Angela Eagle informed the House of Commons that the role of the IRGC extends far beyond that of a conventional military force to encompass "intelligence activity, the use of proxy actors and the projection of influence designed to advance Iranian state objectives". The Islamic Movement of Companions of the Right (IMCR) has been banned for being behind a series of attacks and attempted attacks targeting Jewish communities in the UK and Europe.

AGENCIES

At least 27 dead in Bangkok bar fire



Police officers inspect the site of a fire in Bangkok on Monday AP/PTI

“THE BUILDING’S STREET-FACING WINDOWS HAD BEEN BLOWN OUT AND DEBRIS LITTERED THE SIDEWALK”

burned-out tables, some still holding empty beer bottles, stood inside.

Thai national police chief Kittharath Punpetch said most of the dead were found trapped in windowless bathrooms near one of the rear exits of the bar, where they may have sheltered to escape the flames in the hall.

He said the exit had not been used, and people may have been obstructed from reaching it by a table set up in the hall to sell candy, or because it was too dark to find it.

AGENCIES

speakers and an electric guitar. From outside, the scale of the devastation was visible through the shattered windows, where

BANGKOK: A huge fire tore through a music bar in Bangkok overnight, killing at least 27 people and leaving 25 hospitalised in critical condition in the Thai capital's most deadly blaze in 17 years.

Photos from the Rong Beer Na Ladprao bar in a northern part of the Thai capital showed people fleeing as flames shot out the single-story building and thick black smoke billowed into the sky. Shoes lost and scattered as their owners sought to flee could be seen in pictures from the aftermath of the tragedy.

Bangkok city officials said the fire broke out shortly before midnight Sunday, and it was about half an hour until firefighters brought it under control.

By daylight Monday morning, the site had been cordoned off as dozens of Thai forensic officers combed through the burned remains for clues about what caused the fire.

The building's street-facing windows had been blown out and debris littered the sidewalk, including charred television sets,

AT PARIS MEETING

Zelenskyy seeks more EU air defense support



French President Emmanuel Macron (right), shakes hands with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy during meeting in Paris AP/PTI

PARIS: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy went to Paris on Monday to ask two dozen European leaders for help developing measures against Russia's ballistic missiles, which have pummeled his country in the more than four years since Moscow launched a full-scale invasion.

Russian President Vladimir Putin was unyielding, however, vowing emphatic retaliation to Kyiv's recent long-range attacks on refineries, tankers and terminals that have caused widespread fuel shortages. "Wherever they attempt to strike Russian ter-

ritory, we will respond in kind, but our strikes will be several times more powerful," Putin told a meeting with pro-Kremlin activists. European foreign ministers were meeting separately in Brussels where they were expected to discuss Ukraine's needs and Russia's threats to the continent.

"Our top priority is anti-ballistic defense," Zelenskyy said on social media after arriving in Paris.

Zelenskyy is keen to accelerate plans for jointly developing with European countries anti-ballistic air defenses ahead of the winter.

AGENCIES

NASA astronaut Anil Menon to fly to ISS today

WASHINGTON: Anil Menon, a NASA astronaut of Indian descent, is set to embark on an eight-month mission to the International Space Station on Tuesday from the Baikonur cosmodrome in Kazakhstan along with two Russian cosmonauts.

The Roscosmos Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft is scheduled for lift-off from the Baikonur spaceport at 8:17 p.m. (IST) on Tuesday and is expected to dock at the orbital laboratory after a little over three hours.

Besides Menon, Russian cosmonauts Pyotr Dubrov and Anna Kikina will be part of the 75th expedition to the ISS.



Anil Menon

The Soyuz spacecraft will dock at the ISS at 11:56 p.m. IST on Tuesday, and the astronauts will be onboard the ISS at around 1:25 am IST early Wednesday.

Once aboard, the trio will join NASA astronauts Jessica Meir, Jack Hathaway, and Chris Williams, European Space Agency astronaut Sophie Adenot, and Roscosmos cosmonauts Sergey Kud-Sverchokov, Sergei Mikaev, and Andrey Fedyaev.

Born in Minneapolis to Ukrainian and Indian immigrants, Menon is an emergency medicine physician and a US Space Force colonel.

During his stint with the US Air Force, he served on the frontlines in Afghanistan during Operation Enduring

Besides Menon, Russian cosmonauts Pyotr Dubrov and Anna Kikina will be part of the 75th expedition to the International Space Station

Freedom and also worked for the Himalayan Rescue Association, caring for climbers on Mount Everest.

Menon, 49, has also spent a year in India as a Rotary Ambassadorial Scholar to study and support Polio vaccination initiatives.

He is scheduled to travel to space aboard the Roscosmos Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft along with cosmonauts Pyotr Dubrov and Anna Kikina. Menon began his career at NASA as a flight surgeon in 2014 and worked with astronauts living and working on the International Space Station.

AGENCIES

EU, partners launch \$1bn scheme to help Gaza

BRUSSELS: The European Union coordinated efforts to raise 900 million euros (\$1 billion) in aid for Gaza, working with 65 governments and organizations including the White House and the United Nations, the bloc's top diplomat said Monday.

Kaja Kallas announced the fund after a meeting of the Palestine Donors Group in Brussels.

"The EU is the most credible supporter, for the Palestinian people. We are the largest

Key Points

- » Kaja Kallas announced the fund after a meeting of the Palestine Donors Group in Brussels
- » The meeting was the second gathering of the Team Gaza Initiative

AT LEAST 1,098 PALESTINIANS HAVE BEEN KILLED SINCE THE CEASEFIRE

donor and the strongest backer of the two-state solution," she said.

The meeting was the second

gathering of the Team Gaza Initiative, an effort by the EU to rally support for recovery projects like sanitation and farming

in the destitute and war-ravaged coastal enclave of some 2 million people.

At least 1,098 Palestinians, including at least 260 children, have been killed since the ceasefire, according to Gaza's Health Ministry. Five Israeli soldiers have been killed in that time.

The Oct 7, 2023, attack by Hamas-led militants that sparked the war killed some 1,200 people in Israel and saw 251 others taken hostage.

AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 CrPC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sudesh Yadav S/o Chander Pal R/o H.No. 474, New Ashok Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 445/2018 U/s 341/324/506/34 IPC at P.S. Badarpur, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrants of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sudesh Yadav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sudesh Yadav** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sudesh Yadav of FIR No. 445/2018 U/s 341/324/506/34 IPC of P.S.: Badarpur, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.08.2026**.

By order
Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
South East District Court No.515
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/9594/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu Kumar, S/o Ratan Lal, R/o H.No. 46, Nathupura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 280/22, U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sonu Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sonu Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonu Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 280/22, U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.08.2026**.

By Order - Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 06, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9285/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sheikh Imran S/o Sheikh Abu Bakkar R/o C-109, Gali No. 1, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 00040/2018 U/s 411 IPC.,** has been registered at **PS: Jahangirpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sheikh Imran** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sheikh Imran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sheikh Imran** under **FIR No. 00040/2018 U/s 411 IPC.,** registered at **PS: Jahangirpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
JMFC (North District), Room No. 06
1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9539/NW/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY		
Corrigendum Notice		
Tender No. 365135		Dated: 13.07.2026
Corrigendum Details Corrigendum No 6	Corrigendum Publish Date 13.07.2026	
Tender Details Tender No 365135 (Open Tender)		Closing Date/Time 22.07.2026, 15:00
Name of Work: Comprehensive Maintenance Contract of Vande Bharat Express Trainset		
Item Modified NIT Header		
Field Name	Existing Value	Modified Value
Tender Closing Date Time	15.07.2026, 15:00	22.07.2026, 15:00
2409/2026		
Serving Customers With A Smile		

75th Anniversary
आज़ादी का अमृत महोत्सव

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION SATWARI
SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Shorte-NIT No.41 of 2026-27 Dated 08-07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State / Central Government for each of the following works:-

S.No	Name of Work	Advertised Cost (In Lacs)	Cost of documents (In Rupees)	Earnest Money (In Rupees)	Time Allowed for complete-on	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Macadamization of Roads From the H/o Nareish Kumar to the H/o Parshatam Lal Railway line Khuttian Pyl Kotli Shah Daula	60.00	1500/-	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	31/07/2026	A/Hot mix Plant

Position of AAA : Accorded
Position of TS-Accorded
Major head of account :- City & Town 2026-27
The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	10-07-2026 at 1800 Hrs.
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	10-07-2026 at 1800 Hrs.
3	Date, time and place of pre-bid meeting	15/07/2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari
4	Bid submission Start Date	10/07/2026 at 1800 Hrs.
5	Bid Submission End Date	30/07/2026 upto 1600 Hrs.
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	31/07/2026 on or after 13.00 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari and upload the same i.e treasury challan/receipt, Earnest money/bid security in shape of CDR/ FDR/ BG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari. The CDR/ FDR/ BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari at the time of allotment.
2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder need not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder with in the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential-submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.
3. The date and time of opening of Financial Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.jktenders.gov.in and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari. The date for same shall be intimated separately.
4. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of technical bids.
5. The earnest money shall be forfeited, if:-
a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on some day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.
6. Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.
Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.jktenders.gov.in to acquaint bid submission process. To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get "Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)" as per Information Technology Act-2000. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors. The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic form at with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.
Note:- Scan all the documents on 100 dpi with black and white option.
7. The department will not be responsible for any delay in online submission due to any reasons.
8. Scanned copy of cost of tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Const. Divn. No. Satwari Jammu and upload the same i.e treasury challan/receipt, Earnest money/bid security in shape of CDR/ FDR/ BG pledged to Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Satwari and Correctness of information on the notarized affidavit which must be notarized between the period of downloading of bidding document as per the form at mentioned in the e-NIT/SBD with the technical documents of the bid.
9. Bidders may contact office of the Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department, Jammu or concerned Executive Engineer for any guidance for getting DSC or any other relevant details in respect of e-tendering process.
No.-XEN/SAT/PWD/Tender/2026-27/
Dated :-
DIP No:DP/J-5628/26

Sd/- Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
Satwari

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ms. Apoorva Tayal, D/o Shri Ravinder Tayal W/o Shri Tapan Gupta R/o H.No. 180, UGF, Gali No.2, Shalimar Village, Delhi** Also at **Village Nagli Puna, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No.1660/2021 & CC No.1661/2021 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Shalimar Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Apoorva Tayal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Apoorva Tayal** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Apoorva Tayal** of **CC No.1660/2021 & CC No.1661/2021 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Shalimar Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04, North-West District
Room No.112, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9566/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shakil @ Sherni, S/o Wahid R/o H.No. C-341, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.163/2015 u/s 324/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangirpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shakil @ Sherni** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shakil @ Sherni** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shakil @ Sherni** of **FIR No.163/2015 u/s 324/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangirpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North Court No.6
Ground Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9545/NW/2026

‘False, baseless, misleading’: Goyal dismisses report on India-US deal

‘I had fantastic meetings with USTR Greer in June. Both sides renewed their commitment to a balanced & commercially meaningful deal’

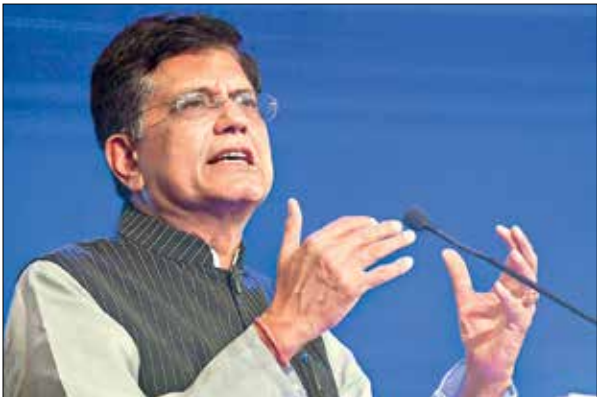
NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Monday dismissed reports of a deadlock in India-US trade talks, calling them as completely false, baseless and misleading. In a post on social media platform X, Goyal rejected an international news agency's report, which had claimed that India was holding out for a better deal with the United States instead of pursuing an early agreement.

“This news is completely false, baseless and misleading,” Goyal said.

The Commerce Minister said he had held “fantastic meetings” with US Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer during the latter's visit to New Delhi in June, and reiterated that both countries remain committed to concluding a balanced and mutually beneficial trade agreement.

“I had fantastic meetings with USTR Jamieson Greer, when he visited Delhi in June. Both sides reaffirmed their commitment to an agreement that is balanced, commercially meaningful, and delivers tangible benefits for businesses, farmers, workers, and consumers in both countries,” Goyal said.

“Our teams remain fully



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said, ‘the Indian team visited US in May. US team visited in June, adding that the ‘talks are going on in proper framework’

engaged in achieving this objective,” he added.

His statement came after Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal also said there are no hurdles in concluding the agreement. Briefing media persons on trade data for June 2026, Agarwal said, “We dont see any challenge on India-US trade deal negotiations.”

The Secretary during the media briefing outlined the recent engagement. “The Indian

team visited US in May. US team visited in June.” He added “Talks are going on in proper framework.”

On the broader trade environment, Agarwal noted US tariff actions have created uncertainty for many partners. “IEEPA tariff has gone...” he said. “Now again they are in discussion with other countries. They are having parallel investigation,” he added. India is part of those discussions. “We have

HIGHLIGHTS

» On the broader trade environment, Agarwal noted US tariff actions have created uncertainty for many partners

» ‘IEEPA tariff has gone...’ he said. ‘Now again they are in discussion with other countries. They are having parallel investigation,’ he added

» India is part of those discussions. ‘We have joined consultations. All progressing in right directions’

joined consultations. All progressing in right directions.”

Both sides have maintained a positive public tone. “Both sides saying things are good...” Agarwal said.

On the status of the deal, he said the framework of the deal is finalised. “India-US framework deal is ready. We are ready to sign. Right time is being awaited,” he said, adding, “Things are getting structured. We are progressing well.” ANI

‘Framework deal is ready, to be signed on right time’

NEW DELHI: India and the US have finalised the framework for a trade deal, which will be signed at an appropriate time, while negotiations on the broader bilateral trade agreement are progressing well, a govt official said on Monday. The official said India is seeking a tariff advantage over competing nations through the pact.

Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal & USTR Jamieson Greer held talks in June on the first phase of the pact.

The official said both sides are clear on framework deal & issues under the BTA, with no differences or challenges in the talks. Bilateral trade continues to expand, supported by rising Indian imports of US energy, reflecting positive ties between the two nations. AGENCIES

Plea on airfares: SC asks Centre to submit rules within two weeks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday asked the Centre to place before it within two weeks the rules framed under the Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024, which is aimed at modernising India's aviation sector.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said the rules be placed before it in a sealed cover, irrespective of whether they have been placed before Parliament.

The apex court passed the order while hearing a plea filed by social activist S Laxminarayanan, who has sought a robust and independent regulator that ensures transparency and passenger protection across the civil aviation sector, and regulatory guidelines to control the “unpredictable fluctuations” in airfare and ancillary charges imposed by private airlines in India.

The counsel appearing for the Centre informed the bench that the draft rules are ready and they are in the process of translation. He said the rules have to be placed before Parliament.

“We grant two weeks’ time to the respondents to place before this court in a sealed cover the rules which have been framed, irrespective of the fact whether they are placed before the Houses of Parliament,” the bench said.

Senior advocate Ravindra Srivastava, appearing for Laxminarayanan, said till the time the new rules come into effect, the old rules are operating. Flag-

ging the “exorbitant airfares” being charged, Srivastava said, “The solution is that this court must consider having a robust and effective regulatory mechanism which is independent.”

The bench posted the matter for further hearing on August 3. While hearing the plea on May 15, the apex court said there should be some rationalisation of airfares and asked the Centre to provide relief to flyers.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who was then appearing for the Centre, told the bench that the new enactment of 2024 had come into effect in January 2025 and the corresponding rules were in the process of being prepared.

On November 17 last year, the top court sought responses from the Centre and others on Laxminarayanan's plea seeking a robust and independent regulator that ensures transparency and passenger protection across the civil aviation sector.

On February 23, the Centre told the apex court that the Ministry of Civil Aviation was actively considering the issues raised in the plea. While hearing the matter in January, the top court said it would interfere with the “unpredictable fluctuations” in airfares and flagged the exorbitant rise during festivals.

The top court had termed the exorbitant rise in airfares by the airlines “exploitation”, and asked the Centre & the Directorate General of Civil Aviation to file their replies on the plea.

The plea claimed that all private airlines have, without any credible justification, reduced

the free check-in baggage allowance for economy class passengers from 25 kg to 15 kg, “thereby converting what was earlier part of the ticketed service into a new revenue stream”.

It said the “new policy of permitting only a single piece for check-in and the absence of any rebate, compensation or benefit to passengers who do not avail themselves of check-in baggage demonstrates the arbitrary and discriminatory nature of the measure”.

The plea claimed that currently, no authority has the power to review or cap airfares or ancillary fees, allowing the airlines to exploit consumers through hidden charges and unpredictable pricing.

It also said the “unregulated, opaque and exploitative conduct of airlines manifesting in arbitrary fare hikes, unilateral reduction of services, absence of on-ground grievance redressal and unjustified dynamic pricing algorithms directly infringes upon citizens’ fundamental rights to equality, freedom of movement and life with dignity”. The plea said the absence of regulatory safeguards results in arbitrary fare hikes, especially during festivals or weather disruptions, which disproportionately harm the poor and last-minute travellers.

It added that inaction by the state in regulating fare algorithms, cancellation policies, service continuity and grievance mechanisms constitutes a dereliction of its constitutional duty and calls for urgent judicial intervention.

Rupee falls 30 paise to 95.68 against dollar



MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 30 paise to close at 95.68 against the US dollar on Monday, weighed down by elevated crude oil prices after Iran declared the Strait of Hormuz closed.

Forex traders said renewed drone and missile strikes between the US and Iran prompted supply concerns, while elevated crude oil prices and a strong greenback triggered capital outflows.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.72 against the American currency and traded in a range of 95.58-95.86 during the session.

The rupee finally closed at 95.68, down 30 paise from its previous close.

On Friday, the rupee rose 9 paise to settle at 95.38 against the US dollar.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 100.91, down 0.03%.

On the domestic macro-economic front, the Reserve Bank of India on Friday said the country's forex reserves jumped \$7.26 billion to \$674.193 billion during the week ended July 3.

In the previous reporting week, the forex kitty had dropped by \$5.654 billion to \$666.933 billion. PTI

Bharat Tex 2026 opens with delegates and exhibitors from 20+ countries

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Bharat Tex 2026, opened at Bharat Mandapam on Monday and will run until July 17, bringing together exhibitors, buyers and delegations from more than 20 countries on a single platform.

The event was organised by the Bharat Tex Trade Federation, a consortium of Textile Export Promotion Councils and industry bodies, with the support of the Ministry of Textiles.

The Federation said the third edition draws on Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 5F vision, Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign, running the length of the textile value chain.

There will be participation from over 7,000 buyers, 1.3 lakh trade visitors and more

than 1,600 exhibitors across 1.6 million sq ft of exhibition space, showcasing over 20,000 products.

International exhibitors from 14 countries, including the United States, the United Kingdom, Japan, Portugal and Spain, will take part, alongside institutional representation from the United Nations and the European Union.

Federation Chairman Naren Goenka said thousands of exhibitors, 7,000 buyers and delegates from more than 20 countries would attend what he called the most ambitious edition of the event yet.

Co-Chairman Bhadrash Dodhia said over 4,000 B2B meetings and more than 30 memoranda of understanding were expected across the four days, spanning trade, investment, technology and market

access.

On the government side, eight States, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu, are sponsoring the edition, while nine other States and Union Territories are exhibiting.

Dedicated State Investor Connect Sessions will allow participating States to showcase investment opportunities and PM MITRA linkages.

The organisers said ministerial delegations from New Zealand, Sri Lanka, Jordan, Cambodia and Brunei had shown interest in attending.

The edition will feature over 350 speakers from more than 20 countries and upwards of 100 knowledge sessions covering trade, sustainability, technical textiles and global sourcing.

Brewers body BAI urges Bihar govt to review prohibition, proposes regulated alcohol policy

PATNA: The Brewers Association of India (BAI) has urged the Bihar government to review its liquor prohibition policy, arguing that it has failed to curb alcohol consumption while imposing heavy social, economic and administrative costs.

In a letter to Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, BAI Director General Vinod Giri said Bihar had an opportunity to replace an “ineffective prohibition model” with a regulated framework focused on harm reduction.

The association, which represents major brewers including AB InBev, Carlsberg and United Breweries, said prohibi-

BAI estimated that Bihar has foregone nearly Rs 60K cr in excise revenue over the past decade

tion had merely shifted alcohol sales from legal channels to the black market.

According to BAI, over 11.3 lakh cases have been registered and more than 17 lakh people arrested under prohibition laws since 2016, even as illegal liquor seizures continue to rise.

It said the policy has diverted police and judicial resources while organised

bootlegging networks have expanded.

The association estimated that Bihar has foregone nearly Rs 60,000 crore in excise revenue over the past decade, besides losses to the hospitality, tourism and logistics sectors. It also pointed to recurring hooch tragedies, saying the absence of regulated alcohol markets drives consumers towards unsafe illicit liquor.

Citing experiences from Indian states and international markets, BAI said blanket bans have historically failed to eliminate alcohol consumption and instead fuelled black markets.

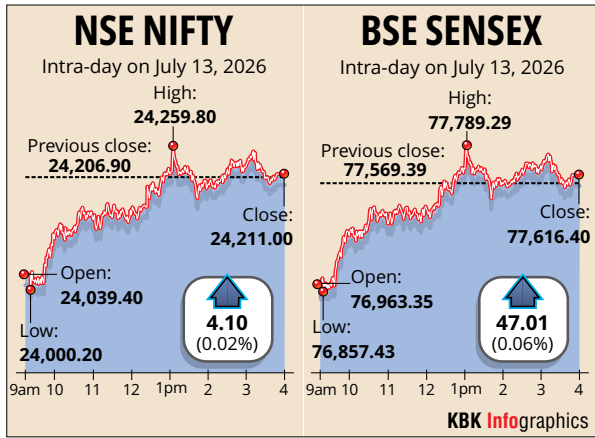
The association proposed a phased introduction of low-

Markets close marginally higher, IT shares cushion decline amid West Asia tensions

MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty recovered from early lows to close marginally higher in a volatile trade on Monday as buying in IT and consumer durable shares helped offset the impact of rebounding crude oil prices and escalation in West Asia tensions.

After a weak start, the 30-share BSE Sensex closed higher by 47.01 points, or 0.06 per cent, to settle at 77,616.40, marking its third straight day of gains.

The index opened sharply down by over 711 points and hit a low of 76,857.43 in early trade. However, buying in IT shares such as TCS and Infosys and consumer durables helped pare losses, with the Sensex rebounding around 931 points from the low to hit a high of 77,789.29. Profit booking in the last hour



erased the gains.

The 50-share NSE Nifty eked out an uptick of 4.10 points, or 0.02 per cent, to end at 24,211, registering its third day of gains. The index hit a low of 24,000.20 and a high of 24,259.8 during

the day.

From the Sensex pack, TCS jumped 5.43 per cent to emerge as the top gainer, while HCL Tech climbed 5.02 per cent, Tech Mahindra 3.34 per cent, Infosys 3.17 per cent, NTPC

2.18 per cent and Kotak Mahindra Bank 1.83 per cent. Tata Steel, Eternal, InterGlobe Aviation, Maruti, UltraTech Cement and Bharat Electronics were among the laggards.

The BSE MidCap Select index went up by 0.51 per cent, while SmallCap Select index dipped marginally by 0.03 per cent. Among sectors, IT surged 3.49 per cent, Focused IT (3.30 per cent), Consumer Durables (0.59 per cent), Utilities (0.35 per cent), Auto (0.31 per cent) and Bankex (0.15 per cent).

Telecom declined 0.96 per cent, FMCG (0.82 per cent), Metal (0.69 per cent), Commodities (0.65 per cent) and Industrials (0.49 per cent).

A total of 2,335 stocks advanced, while 2,068 declined and 189 remained unchanged on the BSE. PTI

IndiGo, Accor announce reciprocal loyalty programmes partnership

NEW DELHI: The country's largest airline IndiGo and hospitality major Accor on Monday announced a strategic reciprocal loyalty partnership in India that will provide various benefits for their loyalty programme members.

The partnership is between the airline's loyalty programme IndiGo BluChip and Accor's loyalty programme ALL Accor.

At an event in the national capital to announce the partnership, IndiGo MD Rahul Bhatia said the opportunities within the Indian travel sector are immense and that the country is one of the world's most dynamic travel markets. MPOST



“This relationship marks a significant milestone in our shared journey and creates a distinctive value proposition for our customers, seamlessly integrating convenient air travel with rewarding hospitality experiences.

“Today's travellers increasingly seek connected and enriching journeys that bring together travel accommodation

and destination experiences in a single cohesive ecosystem,” Bhatia said.

The partnership would allow the members to seamlessly convert ALL Accor reward points to IndiGo BluChips and vice-versa.

“Whether flying with IndiGo across its rapidly expanding network of over 140 destinations within India and abroad, or staying across the ALL Accor's ecosystem, covering more than 45 brands from luxury to economy, members can seamlessly connect flights, stays and experiences, creating a more rewarding travel journey across India and beyond,” a release said. MPOST

Bansal Family to invest ₹10,000 cr in FY27 as M3M expands in NCR

The group has built one of India's largest privately held real estate development bizs, with over Rs 1,28,731 cr GDV

GURUGRAM: The Bansal Family, through its real estate platforms M3M India and Smartworld Developers, has outlined an investment roadmap of around Rs 10,000 crore for FY27 towards construction and strategic land acquisitions as it expands its presence in the National Capital Region (NCR).

The group has built one of India's largest privately held real estate development businesses, with a gross development value (GDV) of over Rs 1,28,731 crore and a fully paid land bank exceeding 3,000 acres across the NCR. It has utilised only about 26% of its land hold-

ings, providing significant visibility for future growth.

The group remains net debt-free, 100% promoter-owned and holds an investment-grade rating, enabling it to pursue expansion while maintaining capital discipline.

Over the past 15 years, the Bansal Family has developed a diversified portfolio across luxury residential projects, branded residences, premium and bridge-to-luxury housing, retail, office and commercial formats. It has delivered more than 30.6 million sq ft across 34 projects, including over 14,000 homes, and is currently devel-

CLOSER LOOK

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- » It has delivered more than 30.6 million sq ft across 34 projects, including over 14,000 homes, and is currently developing 57.2 million sq ft across 40 projects

oping 57.2 million sq ft across 40 projects. It plans to deliver another 1,000 homes over the next three months.

The company said its NCR-focused strategy has helped it emerge among India's top five

real estate developers by FY26 pre-sales, with nearly \$1.8 billion in sales from a single market.

Beyond residential projects, the group has established itself as North India's largest

retail developer with over 11.2 million sq ft of retail assets. It has expanded beyond Gurugram with M3M The Cullinan Emporium in Noida, comprising nearly one million sq ft of premium retail space.

The group's development pipeline includes branded residences (8%), bridge-to-luxury housing (29%), premium residential (26%), luxury residential (19%), retail (13%), office (4%) and industrial (2%) segments.

The Bansal Family also claims the country's largest branded residences portfolio, spanning nearly 6.9 million sq ft through partnerships with

global luxury brands including The Trump Organization, ELIE SAAB and Jacob & Co. The segment has a revenue potential exceeding Rs 20,000 crore, while the group is in discussions to add five to six more international luxury brands.

Its flagship project, The Billionaire's Block at Smart City Delhi Airport in Sector 111, Gurugram, is part of a Rs 3,500 crore investment in ELIE SAAB-branded luxury residences. The development targets India's growing ultra-high-net-worth population and demand for globally benchmarked luxury housing. MPOST

ICICI Pru AMC profit rises 23% to ₹965 cr in Q1

NEW DELHI: ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company on Monday reported a 23 per cent year-on-year jump in its profit after tax to Rs 964.63 crore for the June quarter, aided by higher income.

The company had posted a profit after tax of Rs 783.64 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal.

Total income during the reporting quarter rose 18 per cent to Rs 1,745 crore compared with Rs 1,477.52 crore in the year-ago period, the company said in a regulatory filing.



During the latest April-June quarter, the company paid a final dividend of Rs 12.4 per equity share for the year ended March 31, 2026, as approved by its shareholders at the AGM held last month. Shares of ICICI Prudential AMC settled 1.56 per cent higher at Rs 3209.55 apiece on the BSE. PTI

TRADE DEFICIT WIDENS TO FIVE-MONTH HIGH OF \$30.43 BILLION

Exports rise 15.5% to \$40.41 bn in June, imports up 31% to \$70.84 bn

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's exports rose 15.5 per cent year-on-year to \$40.41 billion in June, while the trade deficit widened to a five-month high of \$30.43 billion due to a surge in imports, driven mainly by higher crude oil prices.

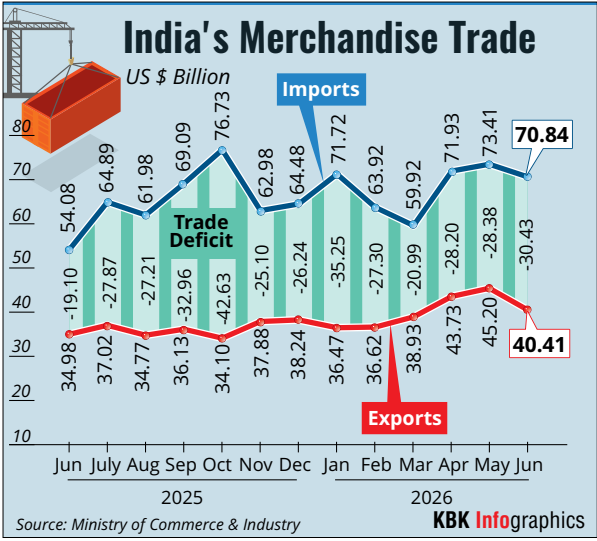
While crude oil imports jumped 40 per cent to \$19.32 billion during the month, the country's overall merchandise imports in June went up by about 31 per cent to \$70.84 billion.

During the first half of June, oil prices were at around \$90 per barrel. The prices have now come down to below \$80 per barrel.

Inbound shipments of precious metals, electronics and machinery too pushed the country's import bill during the last month.

Electronics, machinery and gold imports grew by 58.77 per cent to \$13.4 billion, 30.9 per cent to \$5.8 billion, and 7 per cent to about \$2 billion, respectively, in June.

During April-June this fiscal, exports increased 15.92 per cent to \$129.32 billion, while imports rose 19.89 per cent to \$216.18 billion.



HIGHLIGHTS

» During April-June this fiscal, exports increased 15.92 per cent to \$129.32 billion, while imports rose 19.89 per cent to \$216.18 billion

» Merchandise trade deficit during April-June 2026-27 was \$86.86 billion as compared to \$68.75 billion in the same period last year

» The trade gap in June 2025 was \$19.1 billion and \$34.68 billion in January this year

from the UAE and Oman have registered a positive growth. But it dipped by 29.75 per cent from Saudi Arabia. Indian exporters are using three ports (Duqm, Sohar and Salalah) in Oman to push exports to the region.

The US-Iran conflict has severely impacted the movement of ships carrying cargoes in international waters, particularly through the Strait of Hormuz.

India normally exports goods worth about \$6 billion every month to the region. Meanwhile, India's exports to the US dipped 1.21 per cent to \$8.17 billion in June, while imports grew 33.86 per cent year-on-year to \$5.5 billion, according to government data.

In June 2025, India's exports to the US stood at \$8.27 billion, while imports were reported at \$4.11 billion.

During April-June 2026-27, the country's merchandise exports declined marginally by 0.06 per cent to \$25.46 billion, while imports increased 23.82 per cent to \$16.65 billion.

India and the US are negotiating a trade pact. The US has imposed an additional 10 per cent temporary tariffs for 150 days from February 24.

had declined in March due to the US-Iran conflict, but improved in April and further in May.

"Our exports to the Middle East have evened out," he told reporters here. The shipments in June 2025 were \$4.67 billion.

The country's exports to the UAE rose 3.57 per cent to \$2.7 billion, but shipments to Saudi Arabia declined by 4.42 per cent to \$768.56 million.

On the other hand, imports

Aditya Birla to buy Shell-backed Sprng Energy in \$1.8 billion deal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Aditya Birla Renewables Ltd (ABRen), a unit of Grasim Industries, has agreed to acquire Sprng Energy from Shell Overseas Investment BV in a deal valued at about \$1.8 billion, creating one of India's largest integrated renewable energy platforms.

The transaction values Sprng Energy at an enterprise value of Rs 17,200 crore (\$1.8 billion), the Aditya Birla Group firm said in a statement.

The acquisition will add about 5 gigawatt-peak (GWp) of contracted renewable energy capacity, including around 3.3 GWp of operational assets and 1.7 GWp under construction, taking ABRen's combined portfolio to about 9.3 GWp.

The equity consideration payable to Shell will be determined after adjustments for debt, cash and other items specified in the transaction documents. The acquisition will be funded through a mix of debt and equity from Grasim Industries and funds managed by Global Infrastructure Partners, part of BlackRock, it said.

The deal combines ABRen's commercial and industrial renewable energy business with Sprng Energy's utility-scale portfolio and is expected to close before the end of 2026, subject to regulatory approvals and customary closing conditions.

"Over a long arc of time, the Aditya Birla Group has built businesses at global scale that have contributed to India's long-term growth, be it in building materials, metals, financial services, or retail.

"We view India's energy transition through the same lens. At its core, this is about strengthening our nation's energy future, enhancing industrial competitiveness, and creating the foundations for sustained economic growth," said Kumar Mangalam Birla, Chairman, Aditya Birla Group. "This acquisition brings together two highly complementary platforms and marks an important milestone in ABRen's evolution. Together, we will have a diversified portfolio and a deep development pipeline that puts us on course to scale to 20 GWp+ in the coming years. More importantly, it positions us to participate meaningfully in one of the largest energy transformations underway anywhere in the world," he added.

Aryaman Vikram Birla, Director, Aditya Birla Group and Aditya Birla Renewables, said the acquisition is a pivotal moment in ABRen's evolution, rapidly accelerating its ambition to build a top-tier renewable energy platform at national scale.

"By integrating Sprng Energy's high-quality utilities portfolio with our C&I capabilities, we are significantly enhancing both

the strength and resilience of our combined platform. Additionally, Sprng Energy brings a high-quality asset base, creditworthy off-takers and strong contracted cashflows," he said.

He added, "Having almost achieved our 10 GWp target ahead of time, we are now on track to double capacity in the next few years. This step-up reflects not just scale, but a sharper focus on quality, execution, and long-term value creation."

Jayant Dua, Business Head, Aditya Birla Renewables, said this combination brings together two strong renewable energy platforms with complementary capabilities, geographical presence, customer relationships, and a talented pool of professionals across key functional areas.

"By leveraging our collective expertise across project development, engineering, procurement, construction, and asset management, we believe we can unlock meaningful operational synergies, significantly deepen our organisational capabilities, and accelerate project execution.

"Our priority will be to ensure business continuity, deliver reliable clean power to customers, and continue building a best-in-class renewable energy platform," he said.

The transaction is expected to be completed before the end of the calendar year 2026.

India's defence capex to rise to ₹2.8 trillion by FY30

NEW DELHI: India's defence capital expenditure is projected to grow at an 11 per cent compound annual growth rate (CAGR) over FY2026-30E to reach Rs 2.8 trillion. This structural upcycle is supported by policy measures like positive indigenisation lists and the Defence Acquisition Procedure 2020, which mandate more than 50 per cent indigenous content.

According to a report by Kotak Institutional Equities, Indian defence exports grew 50X over the past decade, driven

by cost-competitive indigenous platforms, proven combat performance in Operation Sindoor, and the easing of export controls.

While the US remains the largest destination, Europe and Armenia are emerging as key new geographies. The report highlighted that "the Rs 500 bn target by FY2029 is the next key milestone," up from Rs 384 billion in FY26.

Technological advancements are also altering spending patterns. Drones are fundamen-

mentally transforming warfare economics, with the global military drone market standing at approximately \$30 billion in CY24. The market is likely to reach \$75 billion by 2029.

"We estimate India will spend \$25-30 bn on drones and \$4-5 bn on counter-drone systems over the next decade," the report added.

As per the report, global military spending surged from \$600-700 billion in the 1990s to \$2.7 trillion in CY24. Sweden-based think tank SIPRI fore-

casts this figure to touch \$6.6 trillion by 2035. India currently ranks as the fifth-largest military spender globally at \$84 billion. The report noted that the country faces an urgent need to scale up defence spending to modernise ageing infrastructure and counter the growing military spending of neighbouring countries. "AoN [Acceptance of Necessity] approvals have surged ~10X over FY2021-26, implying Rs 6.5-7 tn in new orders during FY2027-29E," the report stated.

NEW DELHI: HCL Technologies on Monday posted over 20 per cent year-on-year rise in its consolidated net profit for the June quarter of the current fiscal at Rs 4,624 crore, and the IT major retained its revenue growth guidance at 1-4 per cent for FY27.

The revenue from operations came in at 14 per cent higher at Rs 34,579 crore for Q1FY27, according to a BSE filing. Profit (attributable to owners of the company) stood at Rs 4,624 crore during the



just ended quarter, up from Rs 3,843 crore in the corresponding period of the preceding financial year.

"The Board of Directors has declared an interim dividend of Rs 12 per equity share of Rs

2 each of the company for the financial year 2026-27," the filing said.

The record date for the payment of the interim dividend is July 17, 2026 and the payment date of the interim dividend is July 27, 2026, it added.

Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Chairperson of HCLTech noted that AI is accelerating the transformation of global enterprises and unlocking new growth vectors for the company. "With our differentiated portfolio, we continue to demonstrate our

ability to help clients leverage technology to drive their business strategies. We also remain focused on upskilling our people in emerging technologies and are embedding AI across the organisation," she said.

C Vijayakumar, CEO and Managing Director, said the company recorded its "highest ever" Q1 net-new bookings of \$2.4 billion.

The Advanced AI business grew 10.6 per cent sequentially and 62.1 per cent YoY in constant currency terms.

Sport

The French evolution

New & improved France put past behind as history beckons against Spain

DALLAS: France are one victory from extending one of the most extraordinary eras of World Cup dominance, with a third successive final and a fifth appearance in the showpiece match in eight tournaments within reach when they face Spain on Tuesday.

To get there, Didier Deschamps's side must overcome the team who have repeatedly blocked their path in recent years and whose defence has been breached only once at this tournament.

Spain, who have had a see-saw progression here, eliminated France in the Euro 2024 semi-finals and beat them again in a nine-goal Nations League thriller last year, but this time Les Bleus arrive with the competition's two most prolific forwards - Kylian Mbappe on eight goals and Ousmane Dembele on five - and a much more balanced team.

There is considerable continuity between the teams who met in Munich two years ago, when Spain recovered from Randal Kolo Muani's early header to win 2-1 with goals from Lamine Yamal and Dani Olmo.

Seven of the players who started for France that night could again be in the line-up in Dallas, but the resemblance



Spain will rely on Lamine Yamal to make inroads; while France's Kylian Mbappe will look to add to his 8 goals



largely ends there.

France arrived at the Euro 2024 semi-final as a team still searching for fluency.

Mbappe had been hampered by the fractured nose he suffered in their opening game, Antoine Griezmann was struggling to impose himself and the side had reached the last four despite failing to score freely from open play.

Their progress in the United States has been built on a very different foundation.

Mbappe and Dembele have scored 13 goals between them,

2
La Roja have lost just two of their last 10 meetings with France in all competitions

Michael Olise has provided invention and control between

the lines while Bradley Barcola and Desire Doue have offered another explosive option either from the start or off the bench.

France have become more coherent without the ball and more varied with it, capable of attacking at speed, slowing down the game or defending in a compact block for long periods without appearing uncomfortable.

That tactical flexibility was evident in their 2-0 quarter-final victory over Morocco, when they resisted pressure, denied their opponents clear

chances and waited patiently for the openings that eventually decided the match.

It is precisely that balance which will be tested against Spain, who will be able to rely on Lamine, a player rediscovering his groove after arriving at the tournament nursing a hamstring injury.

Luis de la Fuente's side have retained the collective philosophy that carried them to the European title, using possession not merely to create chances but to suffocate opponents and protect their own defence.

"We are the only ones to have beaten them twice in a row, but this third match will be very different," De la Fuente said after the victory over Belgium.

"These are two very high-level teams who are going to face each other."

France, however, have history within reach.

They reached the World Cup final in 1998, 2006, 2018 and 2022, winning twice, and victory in Dallas would send them into a fifth final in eight tournaments.

It would also make them the first nation since Brazil between 1994 and 2002 to appear in three consecutive World Cup finals.

WALTHAM: France are not afraid of Spain going into their World Cup semi-final on Tuesday, defender Ibrahima Konate said on Sunday, but they are conscious of their opponents' quality and their near-perfect backline.

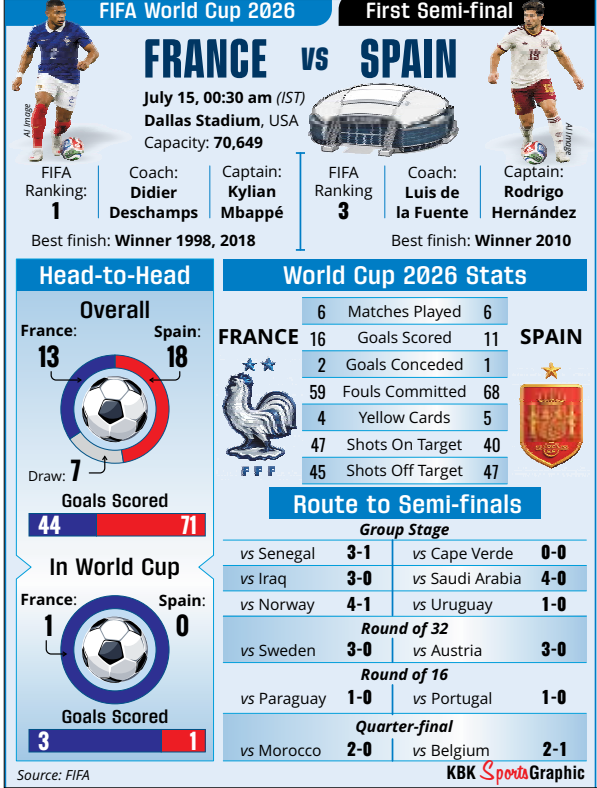
Spain have conceded only one goal in the entire tournament to reach the last four in search of a second World Cup title. France, winners in 2018 and finalists four years ago, know Spain very well, having lost to them in the Euro 2024 last four and also in last year's Nations League semi-finals.

"You cannot fear anyone," France centre-back Konate told a press conference. "We will now prepare as best as possible and hope the result in the end will favour us. Spain are an exceptional team, with a lot of individual quality, so we won't be focusing on just one player even though Lamine (Yamal) is a great player," said Konate, who had a brief substitute appearance in the win over Norway in their final group match.

Dayot Upamecano and William Saliba have been France's starting centre-backs, as the tournament favourites eye their fifth World Cup final.

The French have reached four of the last seven World

Cup finals. Should they take part in the July 19 showdown in New York, they will sustain the comparison with West Germany, arguably the ultimate tournament nation with four finals between 1974 and 1990.



But Konate said the French

were not wasting any thoughts on what might be. "We are staying humble, we won't fall into that trap," he said. They will need to find a way to break down this World Cup's most effective backline, as well as contain Lamine.

Women lord over England for historic Test win

LONDON: A stellar all-round performance fuelled India's famous 270-run win over England in the first-ever Women's Test staged at the iconic Lord's here on Monday.

Needing four wickets to wrap up the game overnight, India completed formalities in the morning session on day four, dismissing England for 186 in 62.5 overs despite a dogged half-century from



The Indian team pose with the trophy

Sophie Ecclestone. It was a clinical performance from India in a format

they don't play often, beating England fair and square in the "Home of Cricket".

Resuming their second innings at 130/6, England batted for more than 90 minutes before succumbing to Indian bowlers. India had set a mammoth 457-run target for the hosts. England's lead scorer Amy Jones (54 off 80) was the first wicket to fall with Sneha Rana having her caught at mid-wicket. Sophie Ecclestone and Issy Wong (1 off 33) only delayed the inevitable.

LONDON: A perfectly-placed topspin lob winner that sailed beyond reach of his 6-foot-6 (1.98-meter) opponent and landed on the outside of the baseline in the second game.

A delicate drop shot which made Alexander Zverev change direction so suddenly that the German player over-extended his right knee at a crucial point of the third set.

Sure, there were plenty of



the usual whizzing, missile-like baseline winners from Jannik Sinner in his four-set victory over Zverev in the Wimbledon

final. He also showed off the new variety of his game, though — which came in handy when Zverev unleashed more power than he had used before against the top-ranked player.

The variety of shots were what Sinner's two coaches, Darren Cahill and Simone Vagnozzi, appreciated most from their player in Sunday's match.

Just like the Big Three and Big Four before them — Roger

Federer, Rafael Nadal, Novak Djokovic and Andy Murray — Sinner, Zverev and Carlos Alcaraz (who is out injured) are continually evolving their games, Cahill noted. "Alexander is now playing a different style of tennis against Jannik," Cahill said. "We saw a lot of the stuff he doesn't normally like doing, even in the final today: sliced backhands, a couple lobs, couple drop shots."

**Bandhan Bank**

Regional Office: Netaji Marg, Nr. Mithakhali Six Roads, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-6. Phone: + 91-79-26421671-75

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
NOTICE is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorized Officer issued demand notice to the borrower(s) on the date mentioned against the account stated hereinafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The borrower(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular the borrower(s) that the undersigned has taken the symbolic possession of the property described herein below under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules on the date mentioned against the account. The borrower(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of the Bank for the amounts, interest, costs and charges thereon. The borrowers'/mortgages' attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Name of borrower(s), Guarantor & Loan Account No.	Description of the property mortgaged (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice	Date of Symbolic Possession Notice	O/s Amount as on date of Demand Notice
Mr. Sitaram C/O Rajendra Mrs. Manju Devi 9000115901121	All That Piece and Parcel of 437.00 Sq. Ft. Situated at Final Plot No.-321, Survey No.-1623, Block/Building No.-Na, Floor No. 0. Building / Society Name -Vayu Enclave 2, Street No. / Name- Plot No 321 Vayu Enclave 1, City-Ghaziabad, State: Uttar Pradesh, Pincode: 201009. Owned By Sitaram C/O Rajendra And Same Bounded As Under: North: Plot No-322, East: Plot No 338, West: Part Of Plot No-321, South: Road 19 Ft. Wide	October 15, 2025	July 10, 2026	Rs.-20,36,474.43

Place: Ghaziabad
Date: July 14, 2026

Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited

**UJVNL Limited**
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Mohanar Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website-www.ujvnl.com

पत्र सं०: 569 दिनांक: 13/07/2026

Tender Notice
Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M-II), Lakhwar, Dakpathar, Dehradun invited online bid from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No.- 02/EE(E&M-II)/LP/2026-27: Electrification of ADM Office, Steel Store by DG Set at Dakpathar.
Tender No.- 03/EE(E&M-II)/LP/2026-27: Shifting of LT Line from Lakhwar Substation to Guest House, Kandriyan Lakhwar MPP.
Estimated cost: 7,97,141.00 (GST extra) & 10,00,000.00 (GST extra), Respectively
Date of availability of bid document on website : 15/07/2026 at 11:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 10/08/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website, "www.ujvnl.com"
EE(E&M-II) Lakhwar MPP
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

UJVNL Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Mohanar Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website-www.ujvnl.com

पत्र सं०: 569 दिनांक: 13/07/2026

Tender Notice
Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M-II), Lakhwar, Dakpathar, Dehradun invited online bid from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No.- 02/EE(E&M-II)/LP/2026-27: Electrification of ADM Office, Steel Store by DG Set at Dakpathar.
Tender No.- 03/EE(E&M-II)/LP/2026-27: Shifting of LT Line from Lakhwar Substation to Guest House, Kandriyan Lakhwar MPP.
Estimated cost: 7,97,141.00 (GST extra) & 10,00,000.00 (GST extra), Respectively
Date of availability of bid document on website : 15/07/2026 at 11:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 10/08/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website, "www.ujvnl.com"
EE(E&M-II) Lakhwar MPP
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Sheikh Moidul@Khokha, S/o: Sheikh Adnan, R/o : Jhuggi No G-660, Jahangir Puri, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 321/16, U/s: 395/397/412/34 IPC & 25/27/54/59 Arms Act, P.S.: Jahangir Puri, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sheikh Moidul@Khokha**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sheikh Moidul@ Khokha**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Sheikh Moidul@Khokha, FIR No.: 321/16, U/s: 395/397/412/34 IPC & 25/27/54/59 Arms Act, P.S.: Jahangir Puri, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms Vandana
Additional Session Judge-02
Room No 202, 1Ind Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9498/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

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CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME

I, **Amit Saini S/o Shri Dharam Singh Saini R/o JA/2, Khirki Extension, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017**, father and natural guardian of my minor son, born on 26th August 2010 hereby declare that my son's name has been changed from **RANNVIJAY SINGH** to **RANNVIJAY SINGH SAINI** henceforth; he shall be known and called by the name **RANNVIJAY SINGH SAINI** for all purposes and records.

I, **Amit Saini S/o Shri Dharam Singh Saini R/o JA/2, Khirki Extension, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017**, father and natural guardian of my minor son, born on 19th May 2009 hereby declare that my son's name has been changed from **DIGGVIJAY SINGH** to **DIGGVIJAY SINGH SAINI** henceforth; he shall be known and called by the name **DIGGVIJAY SINGH SAINI** for all purposes and records.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Tender Notice No. (i) DRMEGGRNC-53-2026, (ii) DRMEGGRNC-54-2026 & (iii) DRMEGGRNC-55-2026, Divisional Railway Manager (Engg), S.E., Railway, Ranchi for & on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders for the following work. **Sl. No., Notice No. & Name of work** are as follows :
1. DRMEGGRNC-53-2026. Execution of work for Flash Butt Welding for 60 kg/60EI-R-260 rails in the jurisdiction of Str. DEN(South)/RNC. **Tender Value : ₹ 1,27,32,972/-, EMD Value : ₹ 2,54,700/-.**
2. DRMEGGRNC-54-2026. Execution of work for Flash Butt Welding for 60 kg/60EI-R-260 rails in different location in Ranchi Division. **Tender Value : ₹ 1,45,51,968/-, EMD Value : ₹ 2,91,000/-.**
3. DRMEGGRNC-55-2026. Execution of work for Flash Butt Welding for 60 kg/60EI-R-260 rails in the jurisdiction of DEN(East)/RNC. **Tender Value : ₹ 2,52,84,044.40, EMD Value : ₹ 5,05,700/-.**
Tender Closing date & time: 07.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs. for each. Tenderers can visit the website www.ireps.gov.in for online tendering. (PR-471)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin.
Narwana
Ishwar singh S/o Dal Singh, R/o Vill. Mahangar Chhapra, Tehsil Uchana, Distt. Jind.
Vs.
1. General Public 2. Auto Ignition Limited, 49 KM Milestone, Mathura Road, Prithla, Palwal 3. Hi-Lex India Pvt.Ltd., Plot No.398, IMT Manesar, Gurugram 4. Ramesh 5. Satish Kumar sons & 6. Mukesh D/o Dal Singh, R/o Vill. Mahangar Chhapra, Tehsil Uchana, Distt. Jind.
Case No. CS/121/2026
CNR No.HR.JNA-1-000137-2026
Next Date :29.09.2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **29.09.2026** at **10:00 a.m.** For details logon to <https://highcourthd.gov.in/hrs> = district Notice&district=Jind

Sd/- Sh. Sandeep Kumar
Addl. Civil Judge Sr. Divin.
Dated 10.07.2026 Narwana

Save Financial Services Pvt Ltd
Corporate and Registered Office: 782, 7th Floor, Vegas Mall, Plot No. 6, Sector 14, Dwarka, New Delhi 110075

POSSESSION NOTICE
(APPENDIX IV) Under Rule 8 (3)
Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Save Financial Services Pvt Ltd, (Formerly Known Karmyogee Finance India Pvt Ltd.), under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned below under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names and addresses mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that the undersigned has taken **Physical possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned herein in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Save Financial Services Pvt Ltd. (Formerly Known Karmyogee Finance India Pvt Ltd.) for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon. The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Name of Borrower, Guarantor	Date of demand notice	Date of Physical Possession	Amount o/s as on date of demand notice
LOANAGUR0000077, 1. Shivam S/O Amar Singh, 2. Amar Singh S/O Bani Singh, 3. Renu D/o Bani Singh, 4. Satyam Thakur S/O Amar Singh, All At - H No 186 Agraula - 2, Loni Ghazabala, Uttar Pradesh 201102, Sr. 1 Also At - Shivam & Work & Shri Balaji Mishra Village Loni Ghazabala, Uttar Pradesh - 201102, Sr. No. 3 Also At - House No. 33/4, Khasra No. 94, Gali Number 15/1, Village Karawal Nagar, North East Delhi, Delhi 110094. Sr. No. 1 Also At - 279, V.P.O Rithala, North West Delhi, Delhi 110085.	28-04-2026	09-07-2026	Rs. 20,05,000.94/- as on 15-07-2025

Description Of The Immovable Property - All That Piece And Parcel Of Freehold Residential Vacant Plot, Area Measuring 300 Sq Yrd Or 250.83 Sq. Mtrs Bearing Khasra No 1/2 Min., Plot No. 186 Situated In The Limit Of Residential Village Loni, Pargana Loni, District Ghaziabad (More Particulars Describe In The Sale Deed Dated 05-07-2011) Uttar Pradesh. Bounded As Below; East: Road 20 Ft, West: Road 50 Ft, North: Road 25 Ft., South: Plot Of Other.

Date - 09.07.2026, Place - Ghaziabad

Authorised Officer, Save Financial Services Pvt Ltd

**GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
PUBLIC WORK DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR TENDER
Tender Notice No. 20 Year 2026-27 (Recall)**

Sr.no	Name of work	Estimated Cost
1.	Appointing Consultant and Project Management Consultancy (PMC) for Reducing Road Fatalities through Identifying, Treating and Improving Black Spots in Thane District	97,98,720,00

1. Period of E-tenders :- Date. 15/07/2026 to Date. 23/07/2026

2. Pre bid conference Date and Place :- Date. 20/07/2026 at 12.00 hrs. the office of the Superintending Engineer Thane (PW) Circle, Thane.

3. Date of Opening (If Possible) :- Date. 24/07/2026 at 12.00 hrs. the office of the Superintending Engineer Thane (PW) Circle, Thane

1. Tender form Condition of Contract Specification and Contract drawing can be downloaded from e-tendering portal of public work Department of Maharashtra i.e. <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

2. Tender Notice can be seen also on website <https://mahatenders.gov.in&www.Mahapwd.com>

No./TD/Tender/ 6810
Office of the Executive Engineer
P.W. Division No.1 Thane
Station Road
Date. 10/07/2026 Dgipr/2026-27/1669

Executive Engineer,
P.W. Division No.1 Thane

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sunita C/o Umesh R/o H. No. 223, Khasra No. 785, B Block, Balbir Vihar, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 487/2022 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunita** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunita** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunita** of case **FIR No. 487/2022 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West, Court No. 109
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9416/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited [CIN : U67190MH2008PLC181062] ("Secured Creditor")**, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 31.07.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of **Rs. 15,79,659/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Seventy Nine Thousand Six Hundred Fifty Three only)** pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDMT00437526, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 08.07.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 09.07.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **NARESH KUMAR GUPTA, SAMPAT RAM AGGARWAL and SAVITRI DEVI**. The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 8,20,000/- (Rupees Eight Lakh Twenty Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be **Rs. 82,000/- (Rupees Eighty Two Thousand only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. SF - 3 (L. I. G.), HAVING COVERED AREA OF 37.16 SQ. MTR. ON 2ND FLOOR, REAR LHS BACK SIDE, SITUATED ON PLOT NO. A - 113, BLOCK - A, KHASRA NO. 392 & 393, S. L. F. VED VIHAR, HADBAST VILLAGE SADDULLABAD, PARGANA LONI, TEHSIL & DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201001, UTTAR PRADESH, ALONG WITH ROOF RIGHTS. THE PROPERTY IS BOUNDED AS UNDER:-
EAST :- COMMON PASSAGE AND FLAT NO. S. F. -4
WEST :- PLOT NO. A-114
NORTH :- PLOT NO. A-100
SOUTH :- FLAT NO. S. F. -2

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.in; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

sdl/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 09.07.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. UGF - 4 (L. I. G.), HAVING AREA 325 SQUARE FEET EQUIVALENT TO 30.19 SQUARE METERS ON UPPER GROUND FLOOR, RIGHT HAND BACK SIDE, (WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS), CONSTRUCTED UPON PLOT NO. F - 31, KHASRA NO. 1305, SITUATED IN SFL VED VIHAR, TEHSIL & PARGANA LONI, GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH AND WHICH IS BOUNDED AS FOLLOWS:-
EAST :- COMMON PASSAGE AND STAIRS; WEST :- PLOT NO. F-26;
SOUTH :- FLAT NO. U. G. F. -3 (L. I. G.); NORTH :- PLOT NO. F-30.
For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.isarc.in; Helpline No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in

sdl/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
INDIA SME ASSET RECONSTRUCTION COMPANY LIMITED
Date : 09.07.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD
Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust

**कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, देवघर**
अल्यकालीन ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना (1st Call)
अति अल्यकालीन ई-निविदा प्रसंग संख्या - RCD/DEOGHAR/1254/2026-27 (1st Call) दिनांक -11.07.2026

1.	कार्य का नाम	लालगढ़-बसकुपी पथ के कि०मी० 5th(P), 6th(P), 7th(P), 8th(P), 9th(P), 10th(P) के विभिन्न पथांशों में साधारण मरम्मत, कि०मी० 1st(P), 2nd(P), 3rd(P), 4th(P) में विशेष मरम्मत एवं अन्य कार्य।
2.	प्राक्कलित राशि (रुपये में)	रुपये 1,80,00,000 /- (एक करोड़ अस्सी लाख रुपये)
3.	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	02 (दो) माह।
4.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	03.08.2026 (12:00 बजे दिन तक)
5.	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशित होने की तिथि एवं समय	21.07.2026 (10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न)
6.	निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का पदनाम	कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, देवघर।
7.	प्रोक्योरमेंट अधिकारी का सम्पर्क नम्बर	06432-299919
8.	ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाइन नम्बर	0651-2446007

नोट – अतिरिक्त जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखें।
प्राक्कलित राशि पद-चढ़ सकती है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता,
PR 384804 (Deoghar)26-27-D पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, देवघर

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person **Namely Bhagat Ram @ Hunny S/o Balkishan R/o H. No. 28/52, Kasturba Nagar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 45870/2018 U/s 379/411/34 IPC PS: Vivek Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bhagat Ram @ Hunny** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bhagat Ram @ Hunny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Bhagat Ram @ Hunny** accused of **FIR No. 45870/2018 U/s 379/411/34 IPC PS: Vivek Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.08.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Mohit Sharma
DP/9598/SHD/2026 C.J.M, Room No. 59, Third Floor, Shahdara (Court Matter) Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Bhanu, S/o Rajesh R/o H.No.E-200, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.455/2017 u/s 323/435/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bhanu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bhanu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Bhanu** of **FIR No.455/2017 u/s 323/435/34 IPC, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North Court No. 6, Ground Floor
DP/9550/NW/2026 Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shyam Lal, R/o H.No.370-371, Sindhi Colony, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi-110042** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No.8273/2016 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shyam Lal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shyam Lal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shyam Lal** of **Case Reg. No.8273/2016 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Bharati Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North District
DP/9462/ON/2026 Court Room No.114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Virender S/o Gajrai, R/o 333, Bazar Mohalla, Tuglakabad Gaon, Jaitpur, Delhi-44, Also at: 40A, 1st Floor, Corner Market, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-110017**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No. 829/2022, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Keshav Puram, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Virender** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Virender** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Virender** the said accused of **Case Reg. No. 829/2022, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Keshav Puram, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
North-West Distt., Room No.-112,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9403/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Deva, S/o: Ram Samajh, R/o: Vegabond, Rani Garden Pushta, Geeta Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 80006668/2024, Dated: 20/01/2024 & U/s: 379/411 IPC, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Deva** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Deva** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deva** of **P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Ld. JMFC-05, 2nd Floor,
Shahdara Distt., Room No. 07,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/9501/SHD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nikhlesh Singh @ Nikki, S/o: Babu Singh, R/o: H.No-B-35B, Tilak Vihar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 106/2020, U/s: 356/379/34 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Nikhlesh Singh @ Nikki** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Nikhlesh Singh @ Nikki** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nikhlesh Singh @ Nikki** of **P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
JMFC-II, West, Room No. 31,
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/9441/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil @ Mochi, S/o: Arjun Ram, R/o: Jhuggi No. 49, Raja Ice Cream Wale Ki Jhuggi, Safeda Jhuggi, Geeta Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 638/2023 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Geeta Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunil @ Mochi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunil @ Mochi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunil @ Mochi** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 638/2023 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Geeta Colony, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Prerna Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (East)
Room No. 15, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/9430/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sumit Kumar R/o H. No. 187, Gudadiya Mohalla, Village Sabha Pur near Post Office Saba Pur, North East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 6076/24 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Pahar Ganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sumit Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sumit Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Sumit Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Sumit Kumar** in **CC No. 6076/24 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Pahar Ganj, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.09.2026 at 10:00 am**.
By order
Sh. Arjun Kirar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Central, CBA-1, Room No.2
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9145/CD/2026

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1947-2026

H'WOOD ACTOR SAM NEILL LEAVES THE WORLD AT 78



The actor achieved his highest level of fame in 'Jurassic Park' playing palaeontologist Alan Grant

Sam Neill, a smoothly elegant and versatile actor whose career moved from art film to blockbuster as he dodged velociraptors in 'Jurassic Park' to playing Holly Hunter's husband in 'The Piano', has died. He was 78.

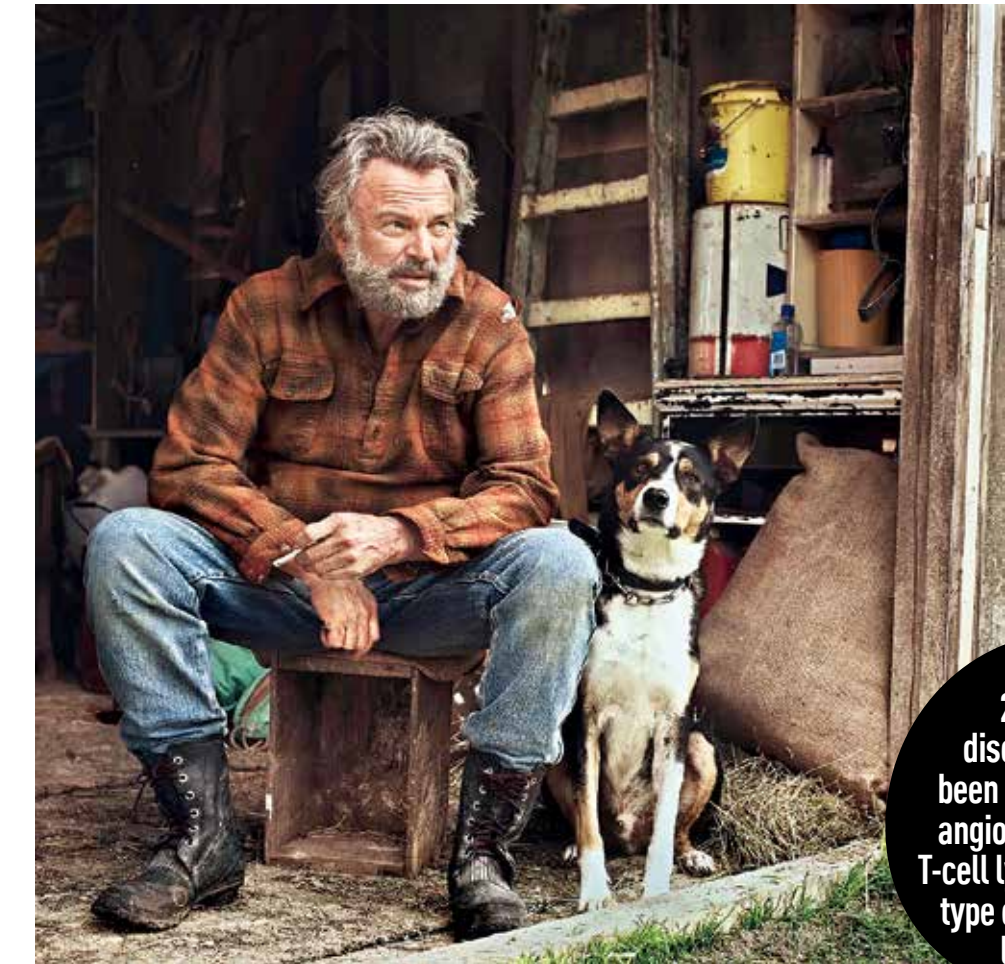
In 2023, Neill disclosed he had been diagnosed with angioimmunoblastic T-cell lymphoma, a rare type of non-Hodgkin lymphoma. Neill died on Monday in Sydney, according to a statement posted to the actor's social media page. His death was 'sudden and unexpected,' the statement said, adding that he 'remained cancer-free' when he died. A cause of death wasn't specified.

"Sam was surrounded by family and passed with the dignity that has characterised his whole life," his family wrote.

The actor came to the world's notice with 'Dead Calm' and 'My Brilliant Career'. Neill was one of a host of actors and directors who achieved international fame after an explosion of Australian films that began in the late 1970s, a list that includes Paul Hogan, Mel Gibson, Geoffrey Rush, Russell Crowe, Jane Campion, Peter Weir and Gillian Armstrong. His range was remarkable, playing opposite Helena Bonham Carter in the Alan Ayckbourn comedy 'Sweet Revenge' to chopping off Hunter's finger in 'The Piano' to poking his own eyes out in the sci-fi horror 'Event Horizon'.

In 'Omen III: The Final Conflict', he played Damien the Antichrist and he also played Cardinal Thomas Wolsey in 'The Tudors'.

The actor first came to the attention of international audiences in Armstrong's 1979 film 'My Brilliant Career', which also introduced Judy Davis. He later appeared in Phillip Noyce's 'Dead Calm', a classy thriller set at sea and co-starring the then-relatively unknown Nicole Kidman.



Neill twice co-starred with Meryl Streep, in Australian director Fred Schepisi's 'Plenty' and again for Schepisi in 'A Cry in the Dark', a film

about the sensationalised aftermath of a dingo killing a baby in the Australian Outback. He earned an Emmy nomination for his performance in the title role of the 1998 miniseries 'Merlin' and another as narrator of 2017's 'Wild New Zealand'.

'Jurassic Park' was his best-known

film. Perhaps Neill achieved his highest level of fame in 'Jurassic Park' playing palaeontologist Alan Grant, who is summoned to an island off Costa Rica where a theme park has been built to house herds of cloned dinosaurs. He co-starred alongside Laura Dern, Jeff Goldblum



and Richard Attenborough.

His character was thoughtful and reasonable, a scientist who warned the mastermind of the theme park before the chaos: "Dinosaurs and man, two species separated by 65 million years of evolution, have just been suddenly thrown back into the mix together. How can we possibly have the slightest idea what to expect?"

Grant survived the harrowing events when the creatures got loose but didn't return for 'The Lost World: Jurassic Park II' in 1997. He came back for the third episode in 2001 and 'Jurassic World: Dominion' in 2022.

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"It's probably a little late to learn these things," he told the 'Daily News' of New York in 2001, "but I finally feel I've worked out how to be an action hero. I'm happier with Grant this time. He's gnarly and grizzled, but he looks like he knows what he's doing."

Neill grew up in Northern Ireland and then New Zealand. Born in 1947 in Northern Ireland, Neill emi-

grated to New Zealand at the age of 7. He was born Nigel Neill but told interviewers he started to go by Sam because there were too many Nigels at his school. His family settled in Dunedin on the South Island and he was sent to boarding school in Christchurch. After college, he took the lead in 'Sleeping Dogs' in 1977, the first feature made in New Zealand in more than a decade.

Neill's other film roles included playing a Soviet submarine officer who memorably dreams of a home in Montana in "The Hunt for Red October" and an investigator in director John Carpenter's 'In the Mouth of Madness'.

On the small screen, Neill played the malign Chester Campbell in TV's 'Peaky Blinders' and Thomas Jefferson in the four-hour CBS miniseries, 'Sally Hemings: an American Tragedy'. On 'Apple TV+', he was on 'Invasion', playing Oklahoma Sheriff John Bell Tyson, a man late in his career searching for his purpose. In 2024, he starred opposite Annette Bening in the 'Peacock' series 'Apples Never Fall'.

The actor is beloved in New Zealand as an unassuming celebrity. He became known in New Zealand as a modest and unassuming person who didn't embrace celebrity. On social media, he often posted images of his farm animals, many of them affec-

tionately named after celebrities and friends, like Laura Dern the chicken, Kylie Minogue the duck and Helena Bonham Carter the cow.

New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon mourned Neill as 'one of the greats' in a statement posted to social media. "He started out when there was barely a film industry to speak of," Luxon wrote. "For more than 50 years, he took New Zealand stories to the world and his talents helped make our film industry into what it is today."

Neill was also a vintner and under his 'Two Paddocks' brand, he produced pinot noir and Riesling wines from his winery in the Central Otago region of New Zealand's South Island.

His memoir 'Did I Ever Tell You This?' came out in March 2023 and he was awarded a knighthood in recognition of his 'outstanding contribution to film', a title approved by the late Queen Elizabeth II.

"I can't pretend that the last year hasn't had its dark moments," Neill told 'The Guardian' in 2023, referring to his cancer diagnosis and treatment. "But those dark moments throw the light into sharp relief, you know and have made me grateful for every day and immensely grateful for all my friends."

He is survived by his four children and eight grandchildren. AGENCIES

'Michael' earns over USD 1 bn at box office



LOS ANGELES: 'Michael', a film on the King of Pop Michael Jackson, featuring his nephew, Jaar Jackson, has emerged as the first biopic to earn over a billion US dollars at the global box office.

The film is directed by Antoine Fuqua, known for projects such as 'Training Day', 'The Equalizer' franchise and others. It was released on April 24 and is distributed globally by 'Lionsgate' and 'Universal Pictures'.

According to the entertainment news outlet 'Variety', the film has earned 629.8 million US dollars overseas and 371.8 million US dollars domestically, bringing the global collection to 1.001 billion US dollars.

It also turned out to be the first film for 'Lionsgate' to earn 1 billion US dollars. Before 'Michael', Lionsgate's highest-grossing releases were 2013's 'The Hunger Games: Catching Fire' with

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865 million dollars and 2012's 'The Twilight Saga: Breaking Dawn - Part 2' with 850 million dollars at the global box office.

Michael Jackson has several tracks to his credit, including 'Billie Jean', 'Beat It', 'Thriller' and others. He died due to acute propofol intoxication in 2009 in Los Angeles. He was 50.

The film chronicles his life from his childhood with the 'Jackson 5' (an American pop group formed in 1964 in Gary, Indiana, by brothers Jackie, Tito, Jermaine, Marlon and Michael Jackson) to his 1980s 'Bad tour'. PTI

Here's why Matt Damon regrets turning down Shekhar Kapur's film

The Oscar-winning actor was in India for 'The Odyssey'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Oscar-winning actor Matt Damon, who is in Mumbai for Christopher Nolan's 'The Odyssey', said not working with Indian filmmaker Shekhar Kapur is one of the biggest regrets of his career. Speaking at the promotion of the film, the 'Good Will Hunting' actor said he had to turn down the 2002 historical war drama 'The Four Feathers' due to a scheduling conflict and he was really upset after that. "I remember that when we were starting out, everyone wanted to collaborate with Shekhar Kapur. I remember when I couldn't do 'The Four Feathers' for some reason; I was really upset about that. I think I was signed up for a 'Bourne' movie. So, I guess, he has always been on my list and I would like to have another go.



Christopher Nolan, Matt Damon and Tom Holland made a quick stop at a cafe in Mumbai for chai before the Indian premiere of 'The Odyssey'

That's like a 20-year-old little debt I've been carrying around in my pocket," Damon said.

Meanwhile, Kapur said there's

no filmmaker in the world who wouldn't want to work with the 'Martian' actor. "I don't think there is a filmmaker in the world

who wouldn't give their right arm to work with an actor who has as much emotional depth as Matt Damon. Who can ever forget his famous scene with Robin Williams, 'It's not your fault' in 'Good Will Hunting'. I must have watched it over a thousand times and been moved to tears each time. Events move between the past, present and the future... while time is created in our imagination... so it's time, Matt, that we finally collaborate," Kapur said. An epic war film, 'The Four Feathers' had Heath Ledger, Wes Bentley, Djimon Hounsou and Kate Hudson.

'The Odyssey' had its Indian premiere in Mumbai, with the filmmaker joined by actors Damon and Tom Holland. Ahead of the event, the three made a quick stop at a cafe for chai before making their way to the premiere.



CELEB POWER AT WIMBLEDON 2026

From Hollywood royalty like Dustin Hoffman, Nicole Kidman, Ben Stiller, Jennifer Lopez and Tom Hiddleston to Indian stars like Priyanka Chopra, Yuvraj Singh, Abhishek Sharma, the final weekend at the 149th edition of the Wimbledon Championships had a starry gathering.



Legend Dustin Hoffman at The Royal Box



Anna Wintour and Nicole Kidman at the stands



Jennifer Lopez & Tom Hiddleston are already enjoying the final at Wimbledon



Priyanka Chopra and Lara Dutt reunite at Wimbledon



Indian cricketers Abhishek Sharma and Yuvraj Singh in attendance



Ben Stiller makes a stylish appearance